50 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Economy & Business

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Advantages / Disadvantages

#19 Advantages / Disadvantages · 266 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of globalization outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Goods, money and ideas now cross borders faster than ever, and the question is whether the advantages of globalisation outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, globalisation raises growth and choice. Open markets bring cheaper goods, investment and technology. A consumer who buys a phone assembled in Asia with parts from several continents, for example, pays much less than she would if every part were made locally. Developing countries have attracted factories and created jobs, and millions of people have escaped poverty through export industries. Companies can reach larger markets, which allows them to grow, and universities and scientists share knowledge across the world. Cultural exchange also brings new food, music and ideas into people's daily lives.

On the negative side, globalisation creates losers and cultural pressure. Workers in uncompetitive industries lose jobs, small firms struggle against multinationals and local cultures may fade. A town whose factory closes because production has moved to a country with lower wages, for example, may suffer for decades. Global supply chains spread diseases, financial crises and pollution, and countries that depend on imports become vulnerable when trade is disrupted. Large companies may also avoid taxes and pay low wages. Nevertheless, these problems can be reduced by retraining schemes, fair labour and environmental standards and international cooperation. Gains must be shared through retraining and fair rules.

In conclusion, globalisation has brought substantial benefits in growth, choice and knowledge. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, provided that governments protect workers and communities who are harmed by change.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Goods, money and ideas now cross borders** — hàng hoá, tiền bạc và ý tưởng nay vượt qua biên giới
- **the advantages of globalisation outweigh the disadvantages** — ưu điểm của toàn cầu hoá lớn hơn nhược điểm
- **raises growth and choice** — tăng trưởng và mở rộng sự lựa chọn
- **Open markets bring cheaper goods, investment and technology** — thị trường mở mang lại hàng rẻ hơn, đầu tư và công nghệ
- **assembled in Asia with parts from several continents** — được lắp ráp ở châu Á với linh kiện từ nhiều châu lục
- **Developing countries have attracted factories** — các nước đang phát triển đã thu hút nhà máy
- **escaped poverty through export industries** — thoát nghèo nhờ các ngành xuất khẩu
- **reach larger markets** — tiếp cận thị trường lớn hơn
- **share knowledge across the world** — chia sẻ tri thức trên khắp thế giới
- **cultural exchange** — giao lưu văn hoá
- **creates losers and cultural pressure** — tạo ra những người thua cuộc và áp lực văn hoá
- **Workers in uncompetitive industries lose jobs** — người lao động trong ngành kém cạnh tranh mất việc
- **small firms struggle against multinationals** — công ty nhỏ chật vật trước các tập đoàn đa quốc gia
- **production has moved to a country with lower wages** — sản xuất đã chuyển sang nước có lương thấp hơn
- **Global supply chains spread diseases, financial crises and pollution** — chuỗi cung ứng toàn cầu lan truyền dịch bệnh, khủng hoảng tài chính và ô nhiễm
- **depend on imports** — phụ thuộc vào nhập khẩu
- **vulnerable** — dễ bị tổn thương
- **avoid taxes and pay low wages** — trốn thuế và trả lương thấp
- **retraining schemes, fair labour and environmental standards** — chương trình đào tạo lại, tiêu chuẩn lao động và môi trường công bằng
- **International cooperation** — hợp tác quốc tế
- **Gains must be shared** — lợi ích phải được chia sẻ

- retraining — đào tạo lại

#68 Advantages / Disadvantages · 276 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of raising the minimum wage.

Several countries have raised their minimum wage in recent years, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of raising the minimum wage before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, a higher minimum wage lifts incomes. Low-paid workers gain purchasing power and motivation. A cleaner or a shop assistant who earns more, for example, can pay rent, buy food and perhaps save a little, instead of working two jobs to survive. The extra money is mostly spent locally, which increases demand and supports businesses in poor areas. Governments also save on benefits, since fewer working families need support. Better pay reduces staff turnover, which lowers recruitment and training costs for employers, and it makes work more attractive than unemployment. Many people believe that a full-time job should provide a living income.

On the negative side, a higher minimum wage may raise business costs. Small firms may cut hours, raise prices or replace workers with machines. A small café that has to pay more to each employee, for example, may hire fewer staff or close early, which reduces opportunities for young people and the unskilled, who need experience most. Prices of services may rise, so that part of the gain is lost. Some economists argue that the increase can cause unemployment, although evidence suggests that moderate increases have limited effects. Moderate, gradual rises work best, together with tax relief for small firms and training for low-skilled workers.

In conclusion, raising the minimum wage has significant benefits for low earners, but it must be handled carefully. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages when increases are moderate and introduced step by step.

Cụm cần nhớ

- raised their minimum wage in recent years — tăng lương tối thiểu trong những năm gần đây
- raising the minimum wage — tăng lương tối thiểu
- lifts incomes — nâng thu nhập
- Low-paid workers gain purchasing power and motivation — người lao động lương thấp có thêm sức mua và động lực
- pay rent, buy food and perhaps save a little — trả tiền thuê, mua thức ăn và có lẽ tiết kiệm một chút
- working two jobs to survive — làm hai việc để sống
- spent locally — được chi tiêu tại địa phương
- increases demand — tăng nhu cầu
- save on benefits — tiết kiệm chi trợ cấp
- staff turnover — tỷ lệ nghỉ việc của nhân viên
- recruitment and training costs — chi phí tuyển dụng và đào tạo
- a living income — thu nhập đủ sống
- raise business costs — làm tăng chi phí doanh nghiệp
- cut hours, raise prices or replace workers with machines — cắt giờ làm, tăng giá hoặc thay công nhân bằng máy
- hire fewer staff or close early — thuê ít nhân viên hơn hoặc đóng cửa sớm
- opportunities for young people — cơ hội cho người trẻ
- Moderate, gradual rises work best — tăng vừa phải và dần dần hiệu quả nhất
- tax relief for small firms — giảm thuế cho các công ty nhỏ
- step by step — từng bước

#88 Advantages / Disadvantages · 283 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of using drones in delivery services.

Small flying machines that carry parcels, medicines and food are being tested in several countries, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of using drones in delivery services before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, delivery drones are fast and reach remote places. They avoid traffic and can carry medicines to villages. A drone that delivers blood to a rural clinic across a river, for example, can complete in fifteen minutes a journey that would take hours by road, and it may save a life. Drones produce fewer emissions than vans for short trips, and they can reduce the number of lorries in city streets. For companies, they cut labour and fuel costs once the system is established. Customers benefit from rapid service, and drones also help in emergencies such as floods, when roads are blocked.

On the negative side, drones are limited by load, safety and noise. Small payloads, battery range, accidents and privacy issues limit their use. A drone can carry only a few kilograms for a short distance, so it is unsuitable for furniture or large grocery orders. Noise disturbs residents, and a falling drone may injure people or damage property, especially in crowded areas. Cameras on drones raise concerns about privacy, and rules on airspace are still developing. Weather such as strong wind or rain can ground the machines. Nevertheless, with clear regulations, designated routes and improved batteries, many of these problems can be managed. They suit special cases rather than all deliveries.

In conclusion, drones offer speed and access in specific situations. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages for urgent and remote deliveries, but they will not replace conventional vehicles.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Small flying machines that carry parcels, medicines and food** — máy bay nhỏ chở bưu kiện, thuốc và đồ ăn
- **using drones in delivery services** — sử dụng drone trong dịch vụ giao hàng
- **fast and reach remote places** — nhanh và đến được những nơi xa xôi
- **avoid traffic** — tránh giao thông
- **carry medicines to villages** — chở thuốc đến các ngôi làng
- **delivers blood to a rural clinic across a river** — giao máu đến một trạm y tế nông thôn bên kia sông
- **complete in fifteen minutes a journey that would take hours by road** — hoàn thành trong mười lăm phút hành trình mất hàng giờ đi đường bộ
- **save a life** — cứu một mạng người
- **fewer emissions than vans for short trips** — ít khí thải hơn xe tải nhỏ ở chặng ngắn
- **reduce the number of lorries in city streets** — giảm số lượng xe tải trên đường phố thành phố
- **cut labour and fuel costs** — cắt giảm chi phí lao động và nhiên liệu
- **rapid service** — dịch vụ nhanh chóng
- **floods, when roads are blocked** — lũ lụt, khi đường bị chặn
- **limited by load, safety and noise** — bị giới hạn bởi tải trọng, an toàn và tiếng ồn
- **Small payloads, battery range, accidents and privacy issues** — tải trọng nhỏ, phạm vi pin, tai nạn và vấn đề riêng tư
- **only a few kilograms for a short distance** — chỉ vài kilôgam cho quãng đường ngắn
- **Noise disturbs residents** — tiếng ồn làm phiền cư dân
- **a falling drone** — một chiếc drone rơi
- **rules on airspace** — quy tắc về không phận
- **clear regulations, designated routes and improved batteries** — quy định rõ ràng, tuyến đường chỉ định và pin được cải tiến
- **can be managed** — có thể kiểm soát

#159 Advantages / Disadvantages · 295 từ · AI 7.0

Do the advantages of a cashless society outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Contactless cards, mobile wallets and online transfers have made banknotes less common, and the question is whether the advantages of a cashless society outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, a cashless society is fast and traceable. Cards and apps speed up payments and reduce theft and tax evasion. A shopper who taps a phone at the till, for example, finishes in seconds, and a street trader who accepts digital payments does not have to carry large sums of cash that might be stolen. Every transaction leaves a record, so it is more difficult to hide income or to launder criminal money, which increases tax revenue. Governments save on printing, transporting and protecting banknotes and coins, and businesses spend less time counting money at the end of the day. Digital payments also make online shopping and international transfers easy.

On the negative side, it excludes some people and weakens privacy. Elderly or poor people may lack bank accounts or smartphones, outages leave shoppers stranded and every purchase is recorded. A person whose card is blocked or whose phone battery dies, for example, cannot buy food, and a power cut can paralyse an entire shopping street. Cyberattacks and fraud are also serious risks, and spending data may be misused by companies or authorities. Cash allows people to budget and to pay anonymously. Cash should remain an option. A balanced approach would encourage digital payment while protecting access to cash for those who need it and ensuring that systems are secure and private.

In conclusion, a cashless society offers convenience and efficiency, but its drawbacks are significant. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages only if cash remains available and privacy is protected.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Contactless cards, mobile wallets and online transfers** — thẻ không tiếp xúc, ví di động và chuyển khoản trực tuyến
- **a cashless society** — một xã hội không tiền mặt
- **fast and traceable** — nhanh và có thể truy vết
- **Cards and apps speed up payments** — thẻ và ứng dụng đẩy nhanh việc thanh toán
- **reduce theft and tax evasion** — giảm trộm cắp và trốn thuế
- **taps a phone at the till** — chạm điện thoại tại quầy thanh toán
- **in seconds** — trong vài giây
- **large sums of cash that might be stolen** — số tiền mặt lớn có thể bị trộm
- **Every transaction leaves a record** — mọi giao dịch đều để lại dấu vết
- **hide income or to launder criminal money** — che giấu thu nhập hoặc rửa tiền tội phạm
- **printing, transporting and protecting banknotes and coins** — in ấn, vận chuyển và bảo vệ tiền giấy và tiền xu
- **counting money at the end of the day** — đếm tiền vào cuối ngày
- **excludes some people and weakens privacy** — loại trừ một số người và làm yếu quyền riêng tư
- **lack bank accounts or smartphones** — thiếu tài khoản ngân hàng hoặc điện thoại thông minh
- **outages leave shoppers stranded** — sự cố khiến người mua mắc kẹt
- **whose card is blocked or whose phone battery dies** — thẻ bị khoá hoặc điện thoại hết pin
- **a power cut can paralyse an entire shopping street** — mất điện có thể làm tê liệt cả một con phố mua sắm
- **Cyberattacks and fraud** — tấn công mạng và gian lận
- **budget and to pay anonymously** — lập ngân sách và thanh toán ẩn danh
- **Cash should remain an option** — tiền mặt nên vẫn là một lựa chọn

#179 Advantages / Disadvantages · 288 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of privatizing services outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Governments in many countries have sold or are considering selling services such as railways, water supply and prisons to private companies, and the question is whether the advantages of privatising services outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, privatising services can raise efficiency. Competition and profit motives encourage cost control and innovation. A railway operator that wants to attract passengers, for example, may introduce better timetables, cleaner trains and online booking, because it loses money if customers go elsewhere. Private firms can raise capital from investors, which allows them to modernise equipment faster than a government with limited budgets. The state saves money when it no longer has to pay for losses, and it can concentrate on regulation and on core tasks such as health and education. Managers in private companies can also dismiss poor performers more easily, which improves quality.

On the negative side, private firms may raise prices, ignore unprofitable areas and form monopolies. A private water company that serves a remote village at a loss, for example, may stop doing so, leaving residents without an essential service. Where there is no real competition, as with pipes or rails, firms can charge high prices and reduce investment while paying large dividends. Workers may face job cuts and lower pay. Strong regulators and clear service duties are essential. Governments should set quality standards, cap prices, require service to all areas and be ready to take control if a company fails.

In conclusion, privatisation can improve efficiency but also threatens access and fairness. On balance, I believe that the disadvantages outweigh the advantages for essential services, although privatisation can be suitable for activities where real competition exists.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **railways, water supply and prisons** — đường sắt, cấp nước và nhà tù
- **privatising services** — tư nhân hoá dịch vụ
- **raise efficiency** — nâng cao hiệu quả
- **Competition and profit motives encourage cost control and innovation** — cạnh tranh và động cơ lợi nhuận khuyến khích kiểm soát chi phí và đổi mới
- **attract passengers** — thu hút hành khách
- **better timetables, cleaner trains and online booking** — lịch trình tốt hơn, tàu sạch hơn và đặt vé trực tuyến
- **loses money if customers go elsewhere** — mất tiền nếu khách đi nơi khác
- **raise capital from investors** — huy động vốn từ nhà đầu tư
- **modernise equipment faster** — hiện đại hoá thiết bị nhanh hơn
- **limited budgets** — ngân sách eo hẹp
- **pay for losses** — trả các khoản lỗ
- **core tasks such as health and education** — nhiệm vụ cốt lõi như y tế và giáo dục
- **dismiss poor performers** — sa thải người làm việc kém
- **raise prices, ignore unprofitable areas and form monopolies** — tăng giá, bỏ qua khu vực không sinh lời và hình thành độc quyền
- **serves a remote village at a loss** — phục vụ một ngôi làng xa với tình trạng thua lỗ
- **an essential service** — dịch vụ thiết yếu
- **no real competition** — không có cạnh tranh thực sự
- **job cuts and lower pay** — cắt giảm việc làm và lương thấp hơn
- **Strong regulators and clear service duties** — cơ quan quản lý mạnh và nghĩa vụ phục vụ rõ ràng
- **cap prices** — áp trần giá
- **take control if a company fails** — tiếp quản nếu một công ty thất bại
- **essential services** — dịch vụ thiết yếu

#188 Advantages / Disadvantages · 294 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of banking online.

More and more customers pay bills, transfer money and check balances on a phone instead of visiting a branch, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of banking online before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, online banking is convenient and cheap. Customers can pay and check balances at any time. A busy employee who transfers rent on a Sunday night from his sofa, for example, saves a trip to a branch and avoids queues, and a traveller abroad can control her account without delay. Transactions are fast, many fees are lower than for counter services, and statements are available instantly, which makes it easier to monitor spending and to spot mistakes. Banks reduce costs by closing branches, and they pass on some savings through better interest rates. Alerts and budgeting tools help customers to manage their money more carefully.

On the negative side, online banking exposes users to fraud and excludes the less digital. Phishing, outages and the loss of branches and personal advice cause problems, especially for older people. A pensioner who receives a convincing email asking for his password, for example, may lose his savings in minutes, and a system failure may prevent customers from reaching their money for hours. Rural communities may be left without a branch, and people who lack internet access or confidence are forced to depend on relatives. Strong security and branch options are needed. Banks should use two-step verification, warn customers about scams, compensate victims fairly and keep some staffed branches or telephone services for those who need them.

In conclusion, online banking brings speed and convenience, but it creates new risks. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, provided that security is strong and traditional services remain available.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **pay bills, transfer money and check balances on a phone** — trả hoá đơn, chuyển tiền và kiểm tra số dư trên điện thoại
- **instead of visiting a branch** — thay vì đến chi nhánh
- **banking online** — giao dịch ngân hàng trực tuyến
- **convenient and cheap** — tiện lợi và rẻ
- **pay and check balances at any time** — thanh toán và kiểm tra số dư bất kỳ lúc nào
- **transfers rent on a Sunday night from his sofa** — chuyển tiền thuê vào tối Chủ nhật từ ghế sofa của anh
- **saves a trip to a branch** — tiết kiệm một chuyến đến chi nhánh
- **control her account without delay** — kiểm soát tài khoản của cô mà không chậm trễ
- **fees are lower than for counter services** — phí thấp hơn so với dịch vụ tại quầy
- **statements are available instantly** — sao kê có sẵn ngay lập tức
- **monitor spending and to spot mistakes** — theo dõi chi tiêu và phát hiện sai sót
- **closing branches** — đóng cửa chi nhánh
- **Alerts and budgeting tools** — cảnh báo và công cụ lập ngân sách
- **exposes users to fraud and excludes the less digital** — khiến người dùng đối mặt với gian lận và loại trừ người ít dùng kỹ thuật số
- **Phishing, outages and the loss of branches and personal advice** — lừa đảo trực tuyến, sự cố và việc mất chi nhánh cùng tư vấn cá nhân
- **a convincing email asking for his password** — một email thuyết phục hỏi mật khẩu của ông
- **lose his savings in minutes** — mất tiền tiết kiệm trong vài phút
- **a system failure** — sự cố hệ thống
- **rural communities** — cộng đồng nông thôn
- **lack internet access or confidence** — thiếu truy cập internet hoặc sự tự tin
- **two-step verification** — xác thực hai bước
- **compensate victims fairly** — bồi thường công bằng cho nạn nhân
- **speed and convenience** — tốc độ và sự tiện lợi

#319 Advantages / Disadvantages · 275 từ · AI 7.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on ethical manufacturing? Use examples.

Some governments encourage factories to pay fair wages, protect workers and limit pollution, and this essay will discuss the benefits for a country that focuses on ethical manufacturing, using examples such as Germany and Bangladesh.

To begin with, a country that focuses on ethical manufacturing gains reputation, skilled workers and sustainable growth. Fair wages and clean production attract responsible buyers, reduce accidents and pollution costs and build trust in exports. Germany, for example, is known for high-quality products made under strict safety and environmental rules, and many consumers are willing to pay more for goods marked "made in Germany". After a deadly factory collapse in 2013, Bangladesh introduced safety inspections and fire standards, which restored the confidence of international clothing brands. Healthy and well-paid workers are more productive and less likely to leave, so firms save on training and recruitment, and fewer accidents mean lower costs.

Furthermore, ethical manufacturing protects the environment and the community. Factories that treat waste water and reduce emissions avoid fines, cleanup costs and damage to local health and farming. Workers who earn enough support their families and spend in local markets, which stimulates the domestic economy. Companies that follow high standards find it easier to enter foreign markets with strict import rules, and investors increasingly prefer responsible firms. The main disadvantage is the higher initial cost of safer equipment and better wages, but long-term competitiveness rises as quality and reputation improve. A country can support its producers with training, loans for cleaner technology and clear, consistently enforced regulations.

In conclusion, a country that focuses on ethical manufacturing benefits through reputation, productivity, environmental protection and long-term competitiveness, despite higher initial costs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **pay fair wages, protect workers and limit pollution** — trả lương công bằng, bảo vệ công nhân và hạn chế ô nhiễm
- **ethical manufacturing** — sản xuất có đạo đức
- **reputation, skilled workers and sustainable growth** — danh tiếng, lao động có kỹ năng và tăng trưởng bền vững
- **Fair wages and clean production attract responsible buyers** — lương công bằng và sản xuất sạch thu hút những người mua có trách nhiệm
- **reduce accidents and pollution costs** — giảm tai nạn và chi phí ô nhiễm
- **build trust in exports** — xây dựng niềm tin vào hàng xuất khẩu
- **high-quality products made under strict safety and environmental rules** — sản phẩm chất lượng cao được làm theo quy tắc an toàn và môi trường nghiêm ngặt
- **willing to pay more** — sẵn sàng trả nhiều hơn
- **a deadly factory collapse** — vụ sập nhà máy gây chết người
- **safety inspections and fire standards** — kiểm tra an toàn và tiêu chuẩn phòng cháy
- **restored the confidence of international clothing brands** — khôi phục niềm tin của các thương hiệu quần áo quốc tế
- **Healthy and well-paid workers are more productive** — người lao động khoẻ mạnh và được trả lương tốt làm việc năng suất hơn
- **training and recruitment** — đào tạo và tuyển dụng
- **fewer accidents** — ít tai nạn hơn
- **treat waste water and reduce emissions** — xử lý nước thải và giảm khí thải
- **fines, cleanup costs** — tiền phạt, chi phí dọn dẹp
- **spend in local markets** — chi tiêu ở chợ địa phương
- **strict import rules** — quy định nhập khẩu nghiêm ngặt
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **higher initial cost** — chi phí ban đầu cao hơn
- **long-term competitiveness** — khả năng cạnh tranh dài hạn

- **loans for cleaner technology** — khoản vay cho công nghệ sạch hơn

#330 Advantages / Disadvantages · 295 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of same-day delivery for consumers.

Some online retailers now promise to deliver goods within hours of an order, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of same-day delivery for consumers before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, same-day delivery is convenient for urgent needs. Customers get goods in hours and can shop online for emergencies. A person whose washing machine breaks down on a Monday morning, for example, can order a part and have it fitted by the evening, and a parent who forgets a birthday present can still please a child on the same day. It saves travel time, particularly for people who are ill, elderly or without a car, and it allows busy workers to shop in the evening. Competition between companies has made the service cheaper than in the past, and some customers enjoy being able to track the courier on a map.

On the negative side, extra fees, fragmented trips, pollution and pressure on couriers make it less attractive in the long term. Many same-day services charge a premium for speed, which means that people pay more for goods that they could have waited for. Vans that make many small deliveries produce more emissions than a single large weekly delivery, and packaging often increases. Couriers who must meet tight deadlines may work long hours for low pay and take risks in traffic. Easy ordering also encourages impulse purchases and returns. Same-day delivery should be reserved for genuinely urgent purchases. Consumers can use standard delivery for ordinary items, group their orders and choose delivery options that are slower but cheaper and more environmentally friendly.

In conclusion, same-day delivery offers real convenience, but its costs for workers and the environment are significant. On balance, I believe that it is useful only in urgent situations.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **deliver goods within hours of an order** — giao hàng trong vài giờ sau khi đặt
- **same-day delivery** — giao hàng trong ngày
- **convenient for urgent needs** — tiện lợi cho nhu cầu khẩn cấp
- **Customers get goods in hours** — khách hàng nhận hàng trong vài giờ
- **shop online for emergencies** — mua sắm trực tuyến cho trường hợp khẩn cấp
- **washing machine breaks down on a Monday morning** — máy giặt hỏng vào sáng thứ Hai
- **order a part and have it fitted by the evening** — đặt một linh kiện và lắp xong trước buổi tối
- **forgets a birthday present** — quên quà sinh nhật
- **saves travel time** — tiết kiệm thời gian đi lại
- **ill, elderly or without a car** — ốm đau, cao tuổi hoặc không có xe
- **Competition between companies** — sự cạnh tranh giữa các công ty
- **track the courier on a map** — theo dõi người giao hàng trên bản đồ
- **extra fees, fragmented trips, pollution and pressure on couriers** — phụ phí, chuyến đi rời rạc, ô nhiễm và áp lực lên người giao hàng
- **charge a premium for speed** — tính phụ phí cho tốc độ
- **Vans that make many small deliveries** — xe tải nhỏ giao nhiều đơn hàng nhỏ
- **a single large weekly delivery** — một lần giao hàng lớn hằng tuần
- **packaging often increases** — bao bì thường tăng lên
- **tight deadlines** — hạn chót gấp gáp
- **work long hours** — làm việc nhiều giờ
- **take risks** — liều lĩnh
- **impulse purchases and returns** — mua sắm bốc đồng và trả hàng
- **genuinely urgent purchases** — những lần mua thực sự khẩn cấp
- **group their orders** — gộp các đơn hàng

#341 Advantages / Disadvantages · 288 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of free trade outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Many countries have signed agreements that remove tariffs and quotas, and the question is whether the advantages of free trade outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, free trade raises efficiency and consumer choice. Removing tariffs lowers prices and widens markets. A family in a small country that can buy cars from Japan, wine from France and clothing from Vietnam, for example, enjoys far more variety at lower prices than it could if only domestic producers were protected. Exporters can sell to millions of customers abroad, which allows them to grow, to hire more workers and to invest in better technology. Competition forces firms to improve quality and to cut waste, and specialisation lets each country concentrate on what it does best. Many economists believe that open trade has increased global income and lifted millions of people out of poverty.

On the negative side, free trade damages uncompetitive sectors. Domestic industries and workers who cannot compete may collapse, and standards can be undercut. A farming region that faces cheap imported grain, for example, may lose many farms, and the communities that depend on them decline. Countries can become dependent on imported food or medicines, which is dangerous in a crisis. Companies may also move production to places with weak environmental or labour laws. Gains outweigh losses only with adjustment support. Governments should provide retraining, regional investment and temporary assistance for those who lose their jobs, and they should include labour and environmental standards in trade agreements.

In conclusion, free trade brings large benefits in efficiency and choice. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, provided that governments protect those who are harmed by it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **agreements that remove tariffs and quotas** — các hiệp định xoá bỏ thuế quan và hạn ngạch
- **advantages of free trade outweigh the disadvantages** — ưu điểm của thương mại tự do lớn hơn nhược điểm
- **raises efficiency and consumer choice** — nâng cao hiệu quả và sự lựa chọn của người tiêu dùng
- **Removing tariffs lowers prices and widens markets** — xoá bỏ thuế quan làm giảm giá và mở rộng thị trường
- **cars from Japan, wine from France and clothing from Vietnam** — xe hơi từ Nhật, rượu vang từ Pháp và quần áo từ Việt Nam
- **only domestic producers were protected** — chỉ các nhà sản xuất trong nước được bảo hộ
- **sell to millions of customers abroad** — bán cho hàng triệu khách hàng ở nước ngoài
- **invest in better technology** — đầu tư vào công nghệ tốt hơn
- **improve quality and to cut waste** — cải thiện chất lượng và giảm lãng phí
- **specialisation lets each country concentrate on what it does best** — chuyên môn hoá cho phép mỗi nước tập trung vào lĩnh vực mình giỏi nhất
- **lifted millions of people out of poverty** — giúp hàng triệu người thoát nghèo
- **damages uncompetitive sectors** — gây hại cho các ngành kém cạnh tranh
- **standards can be undercut** — tiêu chuẩn có thể bị hạ thấp
- **cheap imported grain** — ngũ cốc nhập khẩu giá rẻ
- **depend on them** — phụ thuộc vào chúng
- **dependent on imported food or medicines** — phụ thuộc vào thực phẩm hoặc thuốc nhập khẩu
- **dangerous** — nguy hiểm
- **weak environmental or labour laws** — luật môi trường hoặc lao động yếu
- **Gains outweigh losses only with adjustment support** — lợi ích chỉ vượt thiệt hại khi có hỗ trợ điều chỉnh
- **retraining** — đào tạo lại

- **regional investment** — đầu tư khu vực
- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **labour and environmental standards in trade agreements** — tiêu chuẩn lao động và môi trường trong các hiệp định thương mại

#390 Advantages / Disadvantages · 295 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of universal basic income.

Several countries have tested the idea of giving every adult a regular payment, whatever their income, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of universal basic income before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, universal basic income reduces poverty and insecurity. A guaranteed payment gives everyone a floor, lets people retrain or care for family and replaces complex benefits. A woman who loses her job, for example, can pay for rent and food while she studies for a new career, without waiting for officials to assess her case. Because the money is paid to everyone, there is no stigma and no complicated test, which reduces administration costs and the number of people who fail to claim support. Experiments in Finland and Kenya suggest that recipients often experience less stress and better health. As automation removes some jobs, a basic income could protect people from sudden unemployment and encourage entrepreneurship, since failure is less frightening.

On the negative side, universal basic income is very costly and may weaken work incentives. Paying everyone needs high taxes or cuts in other services, and some of the money goes to people who do not need it. Critics fear that some recipients will work less, though research so far shows small effects. A payment that is too low will not end poverty, while one that is generous may cause inflation, since prices adjust to extra spending power. Pilot schemes should test the effects first. Governments can start with targeted groups or regions, measure the results on jobs, health and spending and then decide whether to expand.

In conclusion, basic income has attractive benefits but serious costs. On balance, I believe that its advantages justify careful testing, although a full national scheme should only follow convincing evidence.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **giving every adult a regular payment** — trả định kỳ cho mọi người trưởng thành
- **universal basic income** — thu nhập cơ bản phổ quát
- **reduces poverty and insecurity** — giảm nghèo đói và bất an
- **A guaranteed payment gives everyone a floor** — khoản thanh toán được đảm bảo tạo cho mọi người một mức nền
- **retrain or care for family** — đào tạo lại hoặc chăm sóc gia đình
- **replaces complex benefits** — thay thế các khoản trợ cấp phức tạp
- **pay for rent and food while she studies for a new career** — trả tiền thuê nhà và thức ăn trong khi cô học nghề mới
- **no stigma and no complicated test** — không bị kỳ thị và không có bài kiểm tra phức tạp
- **fail to claim support** — không xin được hỗ trợ
- **Experiments in Finland and Kenya** — các thử nghiệm ở Phần Lan và Kenya
- **less stress and better health** — ít căng thẳng và sức khoẻ tốt hơn
- **encourage entrepreneurship** — khuyến khích tinh thần kinh doanh
- **very costly and may weaken work incentives** — rất tốn kém và có thể làm yếu động lực làm việc
- **high taxes or cuts in other services** — thuế cao hoặc cắt giảm dịch vụ khác
- **work less** — làm việc ít hơn
- **cause inflation** — gây ra lạm phát
- **Pilot schemes should test the effects first** — các chương trình thí điểm nên kiểm tra tác động trước
- **targeted groups or regions** — nhóm hoặc khu vực mục tiêu

#410 Advantages / Disadvantages · 291 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of privatizing utilities.

Water, electricity, gas and public transport networks were once run by governments in many countries, but several have sold them to private companies, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of privatising utilities before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, privatisation can bring investment and efficiency. Private owners may raise capital from investors, introduce modern technology and reduce waste. A privatised power company that installs smart meters and repairs its network, for example, may cut losses and improve the quality of supply. The government saves money that it would have used for investment, and it can spend it on schools or hospitals instead. Competition between suppliers of electricity or gas can offer customers lower prices and better service, and private managers are free from political interference in decisions such as hiring and pricing.

On the negative side, utilities are natural monopolies, so privatisation risks higher prices and neglect. Water, power and gas networks cannot be duplicated, so customers cannot switch, and private owners may raise bills and underinvest while paying dividends. A water company that pays large dividends but leaves old pipes leaking, for example, harms both customers and the environment. Poor households may struggle to pay rising bills for essential services, and unprofitable rural areas may receive worse service. Where privatisation has been poorly regulated, the results have been disappointing. Public ownership or strict regulation protects consumers. If utilities are privatised, an independent regulator must set price limits, require investment, publish performance data and punish failure, and the government should be ready to take control if a company collapses.

In conclusion, privatising utilities can provide capital and efficiency, but it creates serious risks. On balance, I believe that the disadvantages outweigh the advantages for essential networks.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Water, electricity, gas and public transport networks** — mạng lưới nước, điện, khí đốt và giao thông công cộng
- **privatising utilities** — tư nhân hoá các dịch vụ tiện ích
- **bring investment and efficiency** — mang lại đầu tư và hiệu quả
- **raise capital from investors, introduce modern technology and reduce waste** — huy động vốn từ nhà đầu tư, đưa công nghệ hiện đại vào và giảm lãng phí
- **installs smart meters and repairs its network** — lắp đặt công tơ thông minh và sửa chữa mạng lưới
- **cut losses and improve the quality of supply** — giảm thất thoát và cải thiện chất lượng cung cấp
- **spend it on schools or hospitals** — chi nó cho trường học hoặc bệnh viện
- **Competition between suppliers of electricity or gas** — sự cạnh tranh giữa các nhà cung cấp điện hoặc khí đốt
- **political interference** — sự can thiệp chính trị
- **natural monopolies** — độc quyền tự nhiên
- **higher prices and neglect** — giá cao hơn và sự bỏ bê
- **cannot be duplicated** — không thể nhân đôi
- **raise bills and underinvest while paying dividends** — tăng hoá đơn và đầu tư thiếu trong khi vẫn trả cổ tức
- **old pipes leaking** — đường ống cũ bị rò rỉ
- **Poor households may struggle to pay rising bills** — hộ nghèo có thể chật vật trả hoá đơn tăng
- **essential services** — dịch vụ thiết yếu
- **unprofitable rural areas** — các vùng nông thôn không sinh lời
- **poorly regulated** — được quản lý kém
- **Public ownership or strict regulation protects consumers** — sở hữu công hoặc quy định nghiêm ngặt bảo vệ người tiêu dùng
- **An independent regulator** — một cơ quan quản lý độc lập
- **set price limits, require investment, publish performance data** — đặt giới hạn giá, yêu cầu đầu tư, công bố dữ liệu hiệu suất

#421 Advantages / Disadvantages · 306 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of a cashless economy outweigh privacy concerns? Give reasons and examples.

In some countries, shops, buses and even street vendors no longer accept banknotes, and the question is whether the advantages of a cashless economy outweigh privacy concerns. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, a cashless economy is efficient and harder to abuse. Payments are fast and transactions can be tracked, which reduces crime. A trader who accepts only electronic payments, for example, no longer has to guard a till full of notes or visit the bank each evening, and customers can pay with a touch. Because every payment leaves a record, tax evasion, bribery and money laundering become more difficult, and governments collect more revenue. Printing, transporting and counting cash is expensive, so a digital system saves money. Digital payments also make online business and international trade easier and provide data that help banks to offer credit to people with no collateral.

On the negative side, privacy concerns and exclusion are serious. Every purchase becomes visible to banks and, potentially, to governments and advertisers. A person who buys medicine or donates to a political cause, for example, may not want that information to be stored and analysed. Data leaks and hacking could expose millions of customers, and a system failure can leave citizens unable to buy food. Elderly people, the poor and visitors may lack access to digital payments. Cash should remain an option, and laws should protect personal data by limiting what banks and companies may record and share, giving customers control over its use and punishing misuse severely. Offering anonymous low-value digital payments could also reduce the risk.

In conclusion, a cashless economy offers efficiency and security against crime, but it raises real privacy problems. On balance, I believe that the benefits outweigh the concerns only if strong data protection and cash alternatives are guaranteed.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **shops, buses and even street vendors no longer accept banknotes** — cửa hàng, xe buýt và thậm chí người bán rong không còn nhận tiền giấy
- **a cashless economy** — một nền kinh tế không tiền mặt
- **privacy concerns** — mối lo ngại về quyền riêng tư
- **efficient and harder to abuse** — hiệu quả và khó bị lạm dụng hơn
- **Payments are fast and transactions can be tracked** — thanh toán nhanh và giao dịch có thể được theo dõi
- **accepts only electronic payments** — chỉ chấp nhận thanh toán điện tử
- **guard a till full of notes** — trông giữ quầy đầy tiền giấy
- **visit the bank each evening** — đến ngân hàng mỗi tối
- **pay with a touch** — thanh toán bằng một lần chạm
- **tax evasion, bribery and money laundering** — trốn thuế, hối lộ và rửa tiền
- **Printing, transporting and counting cash is expensive** — in, vận chuyển và đếm tiền mặt thì tốn kém
- **online business and international trade** — kinh doanh trực tuyến và thương mại quốc tế
- **offer credit to people with no collateral** — cung cấp tín dụng cho người không có tài sản thế chấp
- **Every purchase becomes visible to banks** — mọi giao dịch mua đều hiển thị với ngân hàng
- **buys medicine or donates to a political cause** — mua thuốc hoặc quyên góp cho một mục đích chính trị
- **stored and analysed** — được lưu trữ và phân tích
- **Data leaks and hacking** — rò rỉ dữ liệu và tấn công mạng
- **a system failure** — sự cố hệ thống
- **unable to buy food** — không thể mua thực phẩm
- **Elderly people, the poor and visitors** — người cao tuổi, người nghèo và du khách
- **Cash should remain an option** — tiền mặt nên vẫn là một lựa chọn
- **limiting what banks and companies may record and share** — hạn chế những gì ngân hàng và công ty được ghi và chia sẻ
- **anonymous low-value digital payments** — thanh toán số ẩn danh giá trị thấp

- **data protection** — bảo vệ dữ liệu

Discuss both views

#38 Discuss both views · 278 từ · AI 7.0

Some people prefer small local shops while others prefer large supermarkets. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Every town has a choice between a corner shop where the owner knows the customers and a large supermarket with hundreds of products, and opinions differ on which is preferable. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of small local shops argue that they offer personal service and community links. Small shops know their customers and keep money in the area. A grocer who remembers that an elderly neighbour cannot carry heavy bags, for example, may deliver her shopping and keep an eye on her health. Local shops often sell fresh produce from nearby farms, support local jobs and make streets lively, and the owners are more likely to sponsor local sports and festivals. Shopping is quicker for those who live close by, and walking to the shop reduces the need to drive.

On the other hand, supporters of supermarkets argue that they provide low prices and choice. Supermarkets buy in bulk, stock thousands of products and open long hours. A busy family who can buy food, clothes and household items in one trip at a low price, for example, saves both time and money. They also offer car parks, ready meals and loyalty discounts, and many are open until late at night, which suits people who work long hours. Competition between supermarkets keeps prices low, which helps families on tight budgets. However, large stores can drive small shops out of business and often pay suppliers less.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that a mix serves different needs: supermarkets are practical for the weekly shop, but local shops deserve support because they strengthen the community.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a corner shop where the owner knows the customers** — cửa hàng góc phố nơi chủ tiệm biết khách hàng
- **a large supermarket with hundreds of products** — siêu thị lớn với hàng trăm sản phẩm
- **personal service and community links** — dịch vụ cá nhân và mối liên kết cộng đồng
- **keep money in the area** — giữ tiền lại trong khu vực
- **cannot carry heavy bags** — không xách nổi túi nặng
- **deliver her shopping** — giao hàng đã mua của bà
- **keep an eye on her health** — để mắt đến sức khoẻ của bà
- **fresh produce from nearby farms** — nông sản tươi từ các nông trại gần đó
- **make streets lively** — làm đường phố sôi động
- **sponsor local sports and festivals** — tài trợ thể thao và lễ hội địa phương
- **close by** — ở gần
- **walking to the shop reduces the need to drive** — đi bộ đến cửa hàng giảm nhu cầu lái xe
- **low prices and choice** — giá thấp và nhiều lựa chọn
- **buy in bulk, stock thousands of products and open long hours** — mua số lượng lớn, bày bán hàng nghìn sản phẩm và mở cửa nhiều giờ
- **food, clothes and household items in one trip** — thực phẩm, quần áo và đồ gia dụng trong một chuyến
- **saves both time and money** — tiết kiệm cả thời gian và tiền bạc
- **car parks, ready meals and loyalty discounts** — bãi đỗ xe, bữa ăn làm sẵn và giảm giá cho khách hàng thân thiết
- **open until late at night** — mở cửa đến khuya
- **work long hours** — làm việc nhiều giờ
- **families on tight budgets** — các gia đình có ngân sách eo hẹp
- **drive small shops out of business** — đẩy cửa hàng nhỏ đến chỗ phá sản
- **strengthen the community** — củng cố cộng đồng

#85 Discuss both views · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that immigration brings economic and cultural benefits. Others think it causes problems. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

People move across borders for work, study and safety, and opinions differ on whether immigration brings economic and cultural benefits or causes problems. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of immigration argue that it brings economic and cultural benefits. Migrants fill labour shortages, pay taxes and start businesses while enriching food, art and ideas. A nurse who moves from another country, for example, may fill a vacancy that local graduates cannot, and an immigrant who opens a restaurant creates jobs and offers new tastes to the neighbourhood. Many migrants are young and of working age, which helps countries with ageing populations to pay for pensions and health care. Cities that welcome newcomers, such as London and Toronto, are often centres of creativity and trade, because diverse people share different skills and perspectives.

On the other hand, critics argue that rapid arrival can strain housing and services and cause social tension. Schools and hospitals may struggle to cope when numbers rise suddenly, and local workers may feel that they compete for low-paid jobs. In some areas, language differences and separate communities lead to misunderstanding and mistrust. A town whose population grows by a fifth in two years, for example, may find that rents rise and public services are overwhelmed. Integration policy decides the outcome. Language courses, fair access to work, investment in housing and clear rules help newcomers to join society and reduce conflict.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that well-managed immigration brings more benefits than problems, but governments must plan for integration and for the pressure on public services.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **People move across borders for work, study and safety** — con người vượt biên giới vì công việc, học tập và an toàn
- **immigration brings economic and cultural benefits** — nhập cư mang lại lợi ích kinh tế và văn hoá
- **Migrants fill labour shortages, pay taxes and start businesses** — người nhập cư lấp chỗ thiếu lao động, đóng thuế và khởi nghiệp
- **enriching food, art and ideas** — làm phong phú ẩm thực, nghệ thuật và ý tưởng
- **fill a vacancy that local graduates cannot** — lấp một vị trí trống mà sinh viên địa phương không lấp được
- **opens a restaurant** — mở một nhà hàng
- **new tastes to the neighbourhood** — hương vị mới cho khu phố
- **young and of working age** — trẻ và trong độ tuổi lao động
- **ageing populations to pay for pensions and health care** — dân số già hoá chi trả lương hưu và chăm sóc sức khoẻ
- **welcome newcomers** — chào đón người mới
- **centres of creativity and trade** — trung tâm sáng tạo và thương mại
- **perspectives** — góc nhìn
- **Rapid arrival can strain housing and services** — việc đến nhanh có thể gây căng thẳng cho nhà ở và dịch vụ
- **Schools and hospitals may struggle to cope** — trường học và bệnh viện có thể chật vật đối phó
- **compete for low-paid jobs** — cạnh tranh việc làm lương thấp
- **language differences and separate communities** — sự khác biệt ngôn ngữ và các cộng đồng tách biệt
- **misunderstanding and mistrust** — hiểu lầm và thiếu tin tưởng
- **public services** — dịch vụ công
- **Integration policy** — chính sách hội nhập
- **Language courses, fair access to work** — khoá học ngôn ngữ, tiếp cận việc làm công bằng
- **well-managed immigration** — nhập cư được quản lý tốt

#145 Discuss both views · 291 từ · AI 8.0

Some people believe that immigration benefits economies. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Economists and politicians often argue about the effects of newcomers on a country's economy, and opinions differ on whether immigration benefits economies. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that immigration benefits economies in several ways. Migrants fill labour shortages, pay taxes and start businesses. A country with an ageing population, for example, needs young workers in hospitals, farms and construction to support its pensioners. Many entrepreneurs, from small shop owners to founders of technology companies, are migrants, and they create jobs for local people as well. Skilled immigrants bring knowledge and links to foreign markets, while migrants who send money home or return to their countries of origin build trade networks. Studies from several countries show that, on average, immigrants contribute more in taxes than they receive in benefits.

On the other hand, critics argue that immigration can harm parts of the economy. Rapid arrival can strain housing and services, and low-skilled workers may face more competition for jobs and lower wages. A town where many new residents arrive in a short time, for example, may find that rents increase and schools become overcrowded before new capacity is built. Employers may also prefer cheaper foreign workers, which weakens incentives to train local staff. Some countries lose skilled workers through emigration, which is a problem for the countries of origin. Nevertheless, careful policies reduce these effects. Governments can match visas to labour needs, invest in housing and schools in areas that receive many migrants and enforce labour standards so that no group of workers is undercut.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that immigration generally benefits economies, provided that it is managed and that local communities receive support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **the effects of newcomers on a country's economy** — tác động của người mới đến đối với nền kinh tế một nước
- **immigration benefits economies** — nhập cư có lợi cho các nền kinh tế
- **Migrants fill labour shortages, pay taxes and start businesses** — người nhập cư lấp chỗ thiếu lao động, đóng thuế và khởi nghiệp
- **an ageing population** — dân số già hoá
- **young workers in hospitals, farms and construction** — lao động trẻ ở bệnh viện, nông trại và xây dựng
- **support its pensioners** — chu cấp cho người hưu trí
- **founders of technology companies** — người sáng lập các công ty công nghệ
- **create jobs for local people** — tạo việc làm cho người địa phương
- **links to foreign markets** — mối liên kết với thị trường nước ngoài
- **send money home** — gửi tiền về quê
- **countries of origin** — nước nguồn gốc
- **trade networks** — mạng lưới thương mại
- **contribute more in taxes than they receive in benefits** — đóng góp nhiều thuế hơn số trợ cấp họ nhận
- **Rapid arrival can strain housing and services** — việc đến nhanh có thể gây căng thẳng cho nhà ở và dịch vụ
- **competition for jobs and lower wages** — cạnh tranh việc làm và lương thấp hơn
- **rents increase and schools become overcrowded** — giá thuê tăng và trường học quá tải
- **cheaper foreign workers** — lao động nước ngoài rẻ hơn
- **incentives to train local staff** — động lực đào tạo nhân viên địa phương
- **lose skilled workers through emigration** — mất lao động có kỹ năng do di cư
- **match visas to labour needs** — gắn thị thực với nhu cầu lao động
- **enforce labour standards** — thực thi tiêu chuẩn lao động

#165 Discuss both views · 285 từ · AI 7.0

Some people believe that tax incentives encourage innovation. Others think not. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Governments often cut taxes for firms that invest in research, and opinions differ on whether tax incentives encourage innovation. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that tax incentives encourage innovation. Credits reduce the cost of research and attract firms. A pharmaceutical company that can deduct part of its laboratory spending from its tax bill, for example, may decide to hire more scientists and test more drugs. Because new ideas often benefit society more than the firm that produces them, public support can correct this imbalance. Countries such as Ireland and Singapore have used low taxes and research credits to attract technology companies and to create highly skilled jobs. Incentives are also simple to administer compared with grants, and they allow businesses rather than officials to choose projects.

On the other hand, critics argue that incentives do not guarantee innovation. Companies may claim them for work that they would have done anyway, and the lost revenue is spent on activities that produce no new ideas. A large firm that relabels routine product tests as research, for example, receives a tax benefit without improving anything. Tax breaks mainly help profitable firms, while start-ups with no profits gain little. Direct grants, public laboratories and links with universities can be more effective and easier to focus on important problems. Incentives need clear targets and review. Governments should define research carefully, check that claims are genuine, cap benefits and evaluate whether the spending actually leads to patents, products and jobs.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that tax incentives can help innovation, but only when they are well designed and combined with direct support for research.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **cut taxes for firms that invest in research** — cắt thuế cho các công ty đầu tư vào nghiên cứu
- **tax incentives encourage innovation** — ưu đãi thuế khuyến khích đổi mới
- **Credits reduce the cost of research and attract firms** — tín dụng thuế giảm chi phí nghiên cứu và thu hút công ty
- **deduct part of its laboratory spending from its tax bill** — khấu trừ một phần chi phí phòng thí nghiệm khỏi hoá đơn thuế
- **hire more scientists and test more drugs** — thuê thêm nhà khoa học và thử nghiệm thêm thuốc
- **new ideas often benefit society more than the firm that produces them** — ý tưởng mới thường có lợi cho xã hội hơn công ty tạo ra chúng
- **public support can correct this imbalance** — hỗ trợ công có thể sửa sự mất cân bằng này
- **research credits** — tín dụng nghiên cứu
- **highly skilled jobs** — việc làm kỹ năng cao
- **simple to administer compared with grants** — đơn giản để quản lý so với trợ cấp
- **do not guarantee innovation** — không đảm bảo sự đổi mới
- **claim them for work that they would have done anyway** — xin chúng cho công việc mà dù sao họ cũng sẽ làm
- **lost revenue** — nguồn thu bị mất
- **relabels routine product tests as research** — gắn lại nhãn các thử nghiệm sản phẩm thường lệ thành nghiên cứu
- **start-ups with no profits** — các công ty khởi nghiệp chưa có lợi nhuận
- **Direct grants, public laboratories and links with universities** — trợ cấp trực tiếp, phòng thí nghiệm công và liên kết với đại học
- **clear targets and review** — mục tiêu rõ ràng và việc rà soát
- **cap benefits** — đặt trần cho ưu đãi
- **patents, products and jobs** — bằng sáng chế, sản phẩm và việc làm

#205 Discuss both views · 281 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that corporate mergers are good for the economy. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Every year, large firms announce that they will merge with rivals, and opinions differ on whether corporate mergers are good for the economy. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that mergers create efficient, innovative firms. Larger companies share costs, invest in research and compete abroad. Two pharmaceutical firms that merge, for example, can combine laboratories and sales networks, develop new medicines faster and reach more countries. Duplicate offices and factories can be closed, which lowers prices or raises profits, and bigger firms may find it easier to raise money for large projects. In industries that need huge investment, such as airlines or telecommunications, small companies may be unable to survive, so mergers can save businesses and jobs. National champions can also compete with giant foreign rivals.

On the other hand, critics argue that mergers may reduce competition and jobs. Fewer rivals can mean higher prices, less choice and redundancies. A merger between the two biggest supermarkets in a region, for example, may leave customers with little choice and give the new company power over suppliers, who must accept low prices. Staff may lose their jobs when departments are combined, and small competitors may be driven out. Large firms can also become complacent and slow to innovate when they face little competition. Competition authorities should approve only beneficial deals. They can require firms to sell some operations, set conditions on prices and service, or block mergers that would create a dominant position.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that mergers can benefit the economy when they increase efficiency and innovation, but regulators must prevent deals that harm competition.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **large firms announce that they will merge with rivals** — các công ty lớn thông báo sẽ sáp nhập với đối thủ
- **corporate mergers are good for the economy** — sáp nhập doanh nghiệp tốt cho nền kinh tế
- **create efficient, innovative firms** — tạo ra những công ty hiệu quả và đổi mới
- **Larger companies share costs, invest in research and compete abroad** — công ty lớn hơn chia sẻ chi phí, đầu tư nghiên cứu và cạnh tranh ở nước ngoài
- **combine laboratories and sales networks** — kết hợp phòng thí nghiệm và mạng lưới bán hàng
- **develop new medicines faster** — phát triển thuốc mới nhanh hơn
- **Duplicate offices and factories** — văn phòng và nhà máy trùng lặp
- **lowers prices or raises profits** — giảm giá hoặc tăng lợi nhuận
- **raise money for large projects** — huy động vốn cho các dự án lớn
- **airlines or telecommunications** — hàng không hoặc viễn thông
- **save businesses and jobs** — cứu doanh nghiệp và việc làm
- **national champions** — các doanh nghiệp đầu ngành quốc gia
- **reduce competition and jobs** — giảm cạnh tranh và việc làm
- **Fewer rivals can mean higher prices, less choice and redundancies** — ít đối thủ hơn có thể đồng nghĩa với giá cao hơn, ít lựa chọn hơn và sa thải
- **power over suppliers** — quyền lực đối với nhà cung cấp
- **driven out** — bị đẩy ra khỏi thị trường
- **complacent and slow to innovate** — tự mãn và chậm đổi mới
- **Competition authorities** — các cơ quan cạnh tranh
- **sell some operations** — bán bớt một số hoạt động
- **a dominant position** — vị thế thống lĩnh

#218 Discuss both views · 299 từ · AI 7.0

Some people prefer to save money while others prefer to spend freely. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some people put aside part of every salary, while others enjoy their money as they earn it, and opinions differ on whether it is better to save or to spend freely. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of saving argue that it brings security. Savers can meet emergencies and long-term goals. A family with several months of income in the bank, for example, can survive the loss of a job or an unexpected hospital bill without borrowing, and they can pay a deposit on a home or finance their children's education. Saving encourages discipline and reduces stress, because people feel more in control of their future. In old age, savings supplement a pension. Money that is saved and invested also provides funds for businesses to grow, so that it benefits the wider economy.

On the other hand, supporters of spending argue that life should be enjoyed now and that spending supports the economy. Those who never spend miss experiences, and nobody can be sure that they will live to enjoy their savings. A young couple who use their money to travel together, for example, create memories that last for life. Spending also supports shops, restaurants and jobs, and when consumers cut back too much, the economy slows. However, heavy spenders risk debt, and a sudden loss of income can lead to serious difficulty. A budget with both is most sensible. Many financial advisers suggest using a fixed share of income for needs, for wants and for saving, which allows people to enjoy the present while preparing for the future.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that a balance between saving and spending is wisest, with enough saving to be secure and enough spending to enjoy life.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **put aside part of every salary** — để dành một phần mỗi kỳ lương
- **save or to spend freely** — tiết kiệm hay chi tiêu thoải mái
- **Savers can meet emergencies and long-term goals** — người tiết kiệm có thể ứng phó khẩn cấp và đạt mục tiêu dài hạn
- **several months of income in the bank** — thu nhập của vài tháng trong ngân hàng
- **an unexpected hospital bill** — hoá đơn bệnh viện bất ngờ
- **without borrowing** — không phải vay mượn
- **pay a deposit on a home** — trả tiền đặt cọc mua nhà
- **finance their children's education** — chi trả cho việc học của con cái
- **encourages discipline** — khuyến khích kỷ luật
- **more in control of their future** — kiểm soát tương lai của mình nhiều hơn
- **supplement a pension** — bổ sung cho lương hưu
- **funds for businesses to grow** — nguồn vốn để doanh nghiệp phát triển
- **Those who never spend miss experiences** — người không bao giờ chi tiêu bỏ lỡ trải nghiệm
- **live to enjoy their savings** — sống để hưởng khoản tiết kiệm của mình
- **create memories that last for life** — tạo nên những kỷ niệm kéo dài suốt đời
- **supports shops, restaurants and jobs** — hỗ trợ cửa hàng, nhà hàng và việc làm
- **heavy spenders risk debt** — người chi tiêu nhiều có nguy cơ mắc nợ
- **a sudden loss of income** — mất thu nhập đột ngột
- **a fixed share of income for needs, for wants and for saving** — một tỷ lệ thu nhập cố định cho nhu cầu, mong muốn và tiết kiệm
- **a balance between saving and spending** — sự cân bằng giữa tiết kiệm và chi tiêu

#225 Discuss both views · 289 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that global trade benefits all countries. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Ships, planes and cables carry goods, services and money between almost every country, and opinions differ on whether global trade benefits all countries. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that global trade benefits countries on average. Specialisation and larger markets raise efficiency and lower prices. A country with a warm climate that exports fruit and imports machinery, for example, can enjoy goods that it could produce only at a very high cost, and its farmers sell to millions of customers abroad. Trade brings competition, which encourages firms to improve quality and to innovate, and it gives consumers cheaper and more varied products. Many countries in East Asia grew rapidly by exporting manufactured goods and lifted millions of people out of poverty. Trade also creates links between nations that make conflict less likely.

On the other hand, critics argue that gains are uneven and some countries lose. Poorer countries may rely on raw exports with unstable prices, while the profits of processing go elsewhere. Industries that cannot compete close, workers lose their jobs and communities decline. A country that depends on selling a single crop, for example, may suffer badly when its price falls on world markets. Unequal bargaining power allows rich countries to set rules in their favour, and trade can encourage pollution and poor working conditions. Fair rules and support for losers are needed. These include trade agreements that protect labour and environmental standards, aid for developing nations to build industries and retraining for displaced workers.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that global trade benefits most countries over time, but it does not benefit all equally, so cooperation and fair rules are essential.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Ships, planes and cables carry goods, services and money** — tàu, máy bay và cáp chuyển hàng hoá, dịch vụ và tiền
- **global trade benefits all countries** — thương mại toàn cầu có lợi cho mọi quốc gia
- **Specialisation and larger markets raise efficiency and lower prices** — chuyên môn hoá và thị trường lớn hơn nâng cao hiệu quả và hạ giá
- **exports fruit and imports machinery** — xuất khẩu trái cây và nhập khẩu máy móc
- **a very high cost** — chi phí rất cao
- **sell to millions of customers abroad** — bán cho hàng triệu khách hàng ở nước ngoài
- **encourages firms to improve quality and to innovate** — khuyến khích công ty cải thiện chất lượng và đổi mới
- **cheaper and more varied products** — sản phẩm rẻ hơn và đa dạng hơn
- **East Asia grew rapidly by exporting manufactured goods** — Đông Á tăng trưởng nhanh nhờ xuất khẩu hàng chế tạo
- **lifted millions of people out of poverty** — giúp hàng triệu người thoát nghèo
- **conflict less likely** — xung đột ít xảy ra hơn
- **gains are uneven and some countries lose** — lợi ích không đồng đều và một số nước thua thiệt
- **rely on raw exports with unstable prices** — dựa vào xuất khẩu nguyên liệu thô với giá không ổn định
- **profits of processing go elsewhere** — lợi nhuận từ chế biến chảy sang nơi khác
- **cannot compete close** — không thể cạnh tranh và phải đóng cửa
- **when its price falls on world markets** — khi giá của nó giảm trên thị trường thế giới
- **Unequal bargaining power** — quyền thương lượng không bình đẳng
- **Fair rules and support for losers** — quy tắc công bằng và hỗ trợ cho người thua thiệt
- **labour and environmental standards** — tiêu chuẩn lao động và môi trường
- **retraining for displaced workers** — đào tạo lại cho người lao động bị mất việc

#278 Discuss both views · 286 từ · AI 7.0

Some people prefer to use cash while others prefer digital payments. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some shoppers pay with banknotes and coins, while others tap a card or a phone, and opinions differ on whether cash or digital payments are better. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of cash argue that it offers privacy and control. Notes work without power and make spending visible. A person who takes a fixed amount of cash to the market each week, for example, can see exactly how much is left and is less likely to overspend. Cash leaves no digital record, which protects privacy, and it can be used by people without bank accounts, such as children, tourists and the elderly. During power cuts or system failures, cash is often the only way to buy essentials. It also avoids card fees, which small traders must pay for every transaction.

On the other hand, supporters of digital payments argue that they offer speed and records. Cards and apps are faster, safer from theft and easier to track, but they depend on technology. A traveller who pays by phone abroad, for example, avoids carrying large sums and exchanging currency, and a shop assistant does not have to count change. Digital payments produce statements that help people to budget and make it harder to evade tax. They also allow online shopping and instant transfers to friends and family. However, cyberattacks, outages and the risk of overspending are drawbacks. Having both options is practical. People can use digital payments for convenience and keep some cash for emergencies and for situations where privacy or reliability matter.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I prefer digital payments for everyday use, but I believe that cash should remain widely accepted.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **banknotes and coins** — tiền giấy và tiền xu
- **tap a card or a phone** — chạm thẻ hoặc điện thoại
- **cash or digital payments** — tiền mặt hay thanh toán số
- **privacy and control** — sự riêng tư và khả năng kiểm soát
- **Notes work without power and make spending visible** — tiền giấy dùng được không cần điện và làm chi tiêu hiển thị rõ
- **a fixed amount of cash to the market each week** — một khoản tiền mặt cố định đến chợ mỗi tuần
- **overspend** — chi tiêu quá mức
- **leaves no digital record** — không để lại dấu vết kỹ thuật số
- **without bank accounts, such as children, tourists and the elderly** — không có tài khoản ngân hàng, như trẻ em, du khách và người già
- **power cuts or system failures** — mất điện hoặc sự cố hệ thống
- **card fees** — phí thẻ
- **speed and records** — tốc độ và hồ sơ giao dịch
- **safer from theft and easier to track** — an toàn hơn trước trộm cắp và dễ theo dõi hơn
- **pays by phone abroad** — trả bằng điện thoại ở nước ngoài
- **exchanging currency** — đổi tiền tệ
- **count change** — đếm tiền thối
- **statements that help people to budget** — bảng sao kê giúp mọi người lập ngân sách
- **evade tax** — trốn thuế
- **instant transfers** — chuyển khoản tức thì
- **cyberattacks, outages and the risk of overspending** — tấn công mạng, sự cố và nguy cơ chi tiêu quá mức
- **accepted** — được chấp nhận

#434 Discuss both views · 290 từ · AI 8.0

Should individuals be responsible for ensuring fair trade, or should society/government enforce it? Discuss.

Cocoa, coffee, cotton and many other goods are produced by farmers and workers who earn very little, and opinions differ on whether individuals should be responsible for ensuring fair trade or whether society and government should enforce it. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of individual responsibility argue that shoppers can promote fair trade through their choices. Consumers can choose certified goods and press companies for better practice. A customer who consistently buys fair-trade coffee, for example, increases demand for it and encourages shops to stock more, while collective boycotts and social media campaigns have forced several companies to improve conditions. Consumers who ask where products come from send a signal to businesses that ethics matter, and companies depend on their customers. Many people feel that moral duty begins with their own spending, and personal action does not need to wait for legislation.

On the other hand, advocates of government enforcement point out that supply chains are too complex for individuals to check. Shoppers cannot visit factories, and labels can be misleading. A person who buys a shirt that passes through several countries cannot know whether any worker was underpaid. Governments must therefore require transparency and punish exploitation. Laws can oblige companies to investigate their suppliers, ban goods made with forced labour and set minimum standards, while labour inspectors and international agreements enforce them. Fair trade needs informed consumers and enforceable laws. Without legal rules, firms that behave ethically may lose business to cheaper rivals who do not.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that responsibility is shared: individuals should buy ethically where they can, but governments must set and enforce rules that apply to all companies.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Cocoa, coffee, cotton** — ca cao, cà phê, bông
- **farmers and workers who earn very little** — nông dân và công nhân kiếm được rất ít
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **ensuring fair trade** — đảm bảo thương mại công bằng
- **perspectives** — góc nhìn
- **supporters of individual responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **promote fair trade through their choices** — thúc đẩy thương mại công bằng qua lựa chọn của họ
- **choose certified goods and press companies for better practice** — chọn hàng hoá được chứng nhận và gây sức ép buộc công ty cải thiện thực hành
- **consistently buys fair-trade coffee** — mua cà phê thương mại công bằng một cách đều đặn
- **increases demand for it** — làm tăng nhu cầu về nó
- **collective boycotts and social media campaigns** — tẩy chay tập thể và chiến dịch trên mạng xã hội
- **improve conditions** — cải thiện điều kiện
- **send a signal to businesses that ethics matter** — gửi tín hiệu tới doanh nghiệp rằng đạo đức quan trọng
- **moral duty begins with their own spending** — bổn phận đạo đức bắt đầu từ việc chi tiêu của chính họ
- **personal action** — hành động cá nhân
- **supply chains are too complex for individuals to check** — chuỗi cung ứng quá phức tạp để cá nhân kiểm tra
- **labels can be misleading** — nhãn mác có thể gây hiểu lầm
- **passes through several countries** — đi qua nhiều quốc gia
- **underpaid** — bị trả lương thấp
- **require transparency and punish exploitation** — yêu cầu minh bạch và trừng phạt sự bóc lột
- **investigate their suppliers** — điều tra các nhà cung cấp của họ
- **goods made with forced labour** — hàng hoá làm bằng lao động cưỡng bức

- **labour inspectors and international agreements** — thanh tra lao động và các hiệp định quốc tế
- **cheaper rivals** — đối thủ rẻ hơn

#440 Discuss both views · 293 từ · AI 8.0

Some people prefer buying local produce while others prefer imported goods. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some shoppers walk to a farmers' market for tomatoes grown ten kilometres away, while others buy mangoes flown across the world, and opinions differ on whether it is better to buy local produce or imported goods. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of local produce argue that it is fresher and supports farmers. Food grown nearby needs less transport and keeps money in the region. A family that buys vegetables from a farmer in the next village, for example, enjoys produce that was picked yesterday and helps to sustain local jobs. Short journeys mean lower emissions and less packaging, and consumers can learn how their food was grown. Local farms also preserve countryside and traditional varieties, and buying in season encourages a healthy variety of diets. In an emergency, a country with strong local agriculture is less dependent on foreign supply.

On the other hand, supporters of imported goods argue that they offer variety and lower prices. Imported goods supply out-of-season and exotic items often at a lower cost. A shopper in a cold country, for example, can eat fresh fruit in winter and enjoy tea, spices and coffee that cannot grow locally. Specialisation means that some regions can produce food much more efficiently, so that imported produce may even have a smaller carbon footprint than local greenhouse crops. Trade also provides income for farmers in developing countries. However, long supply chains can hide poor labour conditions, and the freshness of imports may be lower. A mix of both suits most households.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that people should buy local produce in season when possible, but they can also enjoy imported goods that cannot be grown nearby.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a farmers' market** — chợ nông sản
- **tomatoes grown ten kilometres away** — cà chua trồng cách đó mười km
- **mangoes flown across the world** — xoài được vận chuyển bằng đường hàng không qua nửa vòng trái đất
- **local produce or imported goods** — nông sản địa phương hay hàng nhập khẩu
- **fresher and supports farmers** — tươi hơn và hỗ trợ nông dân
- **Food grown nearby needs less transport** — thực phẩm trồng gần đó cần ít vận chuyển hơn
- **keeps money in the region** — giữ tiền trong khu vực
- **picked yesterday** — được hái hôm qua
- **sustain local jobs** — duy trì việc làm địa phương
- **lower emissions and less packaging** — khí thải thấp hơn và ít bao bì hơn
- **preserve countryside and traditional varieties** — bảo tồn vùng nông thôn và các giống truyền thống
- **buying in season** — mua theo mùa
- **less dependent on foreign supply** — ít phụ thuộc vào nguồn cung nước ngoài
- **variety and lower prices** — sự đa dạng và giá thấp hơn
- **out-of-season and exotic items** — hàng trái mùa và hàng ngoại lai
- **tea, spices and coffee that cannot grow locally** — trà, gia vị và cà phê không thể trồng tại địa phương
- **a smaller carbon footprint than local greenhouse crops** — dấu chân carbon nhỏ hơn cây trồng nhà kính địa phương
- **income for farmers in developing countries** — thu nhập cho nông dân ở các nước đang phát triển
- **Long supply chains can hide poor labour conditions** — chuỗi cung ứng dài có thể che giấu điều kiện lao động tồi tệ

#480 Discuss both views · 304 từ · AI 7.0

Some people prefer to buy second-hand goods while others prefer new items. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some people hunt through charity shops, online marketplaces and car boot sales, while others prefer the smell and guarantee of something new, and opinions differ on whether it is better to buy second-hand goods or new items. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of second-hand goods argue that they save money and resources. Buying used items cuts waste and cost and can give unique finds. A student who furnishes a flat with second-hand tables and chairs, for example, spends a fraction of the price of new furniture and may find sturdy pieces that are better made than modern ones. Reusing goods reduces the energy and raw materials needed for production and keeps items out of landfill, which helps the environment. Vintage clothing and old books can be unique, and selling used items gives sellers some money back. Children's clothes and toys are used for such a short time that buying new ones often seems wasteful.

On the other hand, supporters of new goods argue that they offer reliability and a warranty. New products are cleaner, come with guarantees and may last longer for essential items. A person who buys a used fridge, for example, may find that it breaks down within months or uses a lot of electricity, while a new model has a warranty and is energy-efficient. For items such as mattresses, helmets and electronic devices, safety, hygiene and up-to-date technology matter. New goods also match exactly what the buyer wants. The choice depends on the item and budget. For furniture, clothes and books, second-hand is often sensible, but for safety equipment and key appliances, new may be better.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that buying second-hand is a smart habit where quality and safety are not at risk.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **charity shops, online marketplaces and car boot sales** — cửa hàng từ thiện, chợ trực tuyến và chợ trời bán đồ cũ
- **second-hand goods or new items** — hàng đã qua sử dụng hay hàng mới
- **save money and resources** — tiết kiệm tiền và tài nguyên
- **Buying used items cuts waste and cost** — mua đồ đã dùng giảm lãng phí và chi phí
- **unique finds** — những món đồ độc đáo tìm được
- **furnishes a flat with second-hand tables and chairs** — trang bị căn hộ bằng bàn ghế cũ
- **a fraction of the price of new furniture** — một phần nhỏ giá của đồ nội thất mới
- **sturdy pieces** — những món đồ chắc chắn
- **the energy and raw materials needed for production** — năng lượng và nguyên liệu cần cho sản xuất
- **out of landfill** — khỏi bãi rác
- **Vintage clothing and old books** — quần áo cổ điển và sách cũ
- **used for such a short time** — được dùng trong thời gian rất ngắn
- **reliability and a warranty** — độ tin cậy và bảo hành
- **New products are cleaner, come with guarantees** — sản phẩm mới sạch hơn, đi kèm bảo hành
- **a used fridge** — một chiếc tủ lạnh cũ
- **breaks down within months** — hỏng trong vài tháng
- **a warranty and is energy-efficient** — có bảo hành và tiết kiệm năng lượng
- **mattresses, helmets and electronic devices** — nệm, mũ bảo hiểm và thiết bị điện tử
- **safety, hygiene and up-to-date technology** — an toàn, vệ sinh và công nghệ cập nhật
- **safety equipment and key appliances** — thiết bị an toàn và các thiết bị gia dụng chính

Agree / Disagree

#55 Agree / Disagree · 274 từ · AI 7.5

Some believe that private companies should pay more taxes. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Governments need money for hospitals, schools and roads, and some believe that private companies should pay more taxes. I agree to a large extent, since companies benefit from public services and should contribute fairly, although very high rates can reduce investment.

To begin with, companies should pay a fair share of tax. Firms use roads, courts and educated workers, so their taxes pay for them. A factory that depends on a highway to deliver goods and on local schools to produce skilled staff, for example, gains from public spending and should help to finance it. Many large companies pay far less than individuals do, because they use accounting arrangements to move profits to low-tax countries. Higher contributions from them would reduce the burden on ordinary workers and allow governments to improve services without raising personal taxes. Public trust also increases when citizens see that powerful firms pay their way.

However, excessive rates may discourage expansion or push profits abroad. If taxes are too high, firms may hire fewer people, raise prices or move their headquarters to countries with lower rates. A start-up that needs every pound to grow, for example, could be harmed by heavy taxation before it makes any profit. Closing loopholes matters more than higher rates. Governments should ensure that existing rules are applied, prevent artificial transfers of profit and cooperate internationally to set a minimum rate, while offering incentives for research and investment. Small companies may need lower rates than large multinationals, which have greater ability to pay.

In conclusion, I agree that private companies should pay more tax, provided that the system is fair and does not discourage genuine investment.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **hospitals, schools and roads** — bệnh viện, trường học và đường sá
- **private companies should pay more taxes** — doanh nghiệp tư nhân nên đóng thuế nhiều hơn
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **benefit from public services** — hưởng lợi từ dịch vụ công
- **pay a fair share of tax** — đóng phần thuế công bằng
- **use roads, courts and educated workers** — sử dụng đường sá, toà án và lao động có học
- **depends on a highway to deliver goods** — phụ thuộc vào đường cao tốc để giao hàng
- **skilled staff** — nhân viên có kỹ năng
- **gains from public spending** — hưởng lợi từ chi tiêu công
- **pay far less than individuals do** — trả ít hơn nhiều so với các cá nhân
- **accounting arrangements to move profits to low-tax countries** — cách sắp xếp kế toán để chuyển lợi nhuận sang các nước thuế thấp
- **reduce the burden on ordinary workers** — giảm gánh nặng cho người lao động bình thường
- **improve services without raising personal taxes** — cải thiện dịch vụ mà không tăng thuế cá nhân
- **pay their way** — tự chi trả phần của mình
- **discourage expansion or push profits abroad** — làm nản việc mở rộng hoặc đẩy lợi nhuận ra nước ngoài
- **move their headquarters** — dời trụ sở
- **every pound to grow** — từng đồng bảng để phát triển
- **Closing loopholes matters more than higher rates** — bịt kẽ hở quan trọng hơn tăng thuế suất
- **a minimum rate** — một mức thuế tối thiểu
- **incentives for research and investment** — ưu đãi cho nghiên cứu và đầu tư
- **pay more tax** — đóng nhiều thuế hơn

#94 Agree / Disagree · 307 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that online reviews influence buying decisions. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Before buying a phone, a hotel room or a restaurant meal, most people now read the stars and comments left by other customers, and many think that online reviews influence buying decisions. I agree with this view, since shoppers trust the experience of other buyers, although some reviews are unreliable.

To begin with, online reviews strongly influence purchases because shoppers trust the experience of other buyers. Star ratings and comments reduce the risk of a poor purchase. A traveller who sees that a hotel has a rating of four and a half stars from two thousand guests, for example, will probably book it rather than a similar one with a lower score. Reviews supply details that advertising does not, such as noise at night, the quality of service or the size of a room, and they come from people who have no reason to sell. Shops that have a high rating attract more customers, and platforms rank products according to ratings, which increases their visibility. Surveys show that most consumers read reviews before they buy.

However, fake or paid reviews can mislead, so careful readers check many sources. Some companies pay people to write praise or post false criticism of competitors, and a few customers write extreme comments because they are angry or have received a free gift. A reader who looks only at the average score may therefore be deceived. Sensible shoppers read several detailed reviews, look for repeated points and consider the number of ratings and the date. Platforms should detect and remove false reviews, and authorities can fine companies that cheat. Businesses must protect their ratings by keeping standards high and by responding politely to complaints, since public opinion online has become a major factor in their success.

In conclusion, I agree that online reviews influence buying decisions, but consumers should read them critically.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **read the stars and comments left by other customers** — đọc số sao và bình luận do các khách hàng khác để lại
- **online reviews influence buying decisions** — đánh giá trực tuyến ảnh hưởng đến quyết định mua hàng
- **trust the experience of other buyers** — tin vào trải nghiệm của những người mua khác
- **unreliable** — không đáng tin cậy
- **Star ratings and comments reduce the risk of a poor purchase** — xếp hạng sao và bình luận làm giảm rủi ro mua phải hàng tồi
- **a rating of four and a half stars from two thousand guests** — điểm bốn sao rưỡi từ hai nghìn khách
- **a lower score** — điểm số thấp hơn
- **Reviews supply details that advertising does not** — đánh giá cung cấp chi tiết mà quảng cáo không có
- **noise at night, the quality of service or the size of a room** — tiếng ồn ban đêm, chất lượng dịch vụ hoặc kích cỡ phòng
- **no reason to sell** — không có lý do để bán hàng
- **platforms rank products according to ratings** — các nền tảng xếp hạng sản phẩm theo điểm đánh giá
- **Fake or paid reviews can mislead** — đánh giá giả hoặc được trả tiền có thể gây hiểu lầm
- **pay people to write praise or post false criticism of competitors** — trả tiền cho người viết lời khen hoặc đăng chỉ trích sai về đối thủ
- **extreme comments** — bình luận cực đoan
- **the average score** — điểm trung bình
- **repeated points** — những điểm được lặp lại
- **the number of ratings and the date** — số lượng đánh giá và ngày tháng
- **detect and remove false reviews** — phát hiện và gỡ bỏ đánh giá giả
- **fine companies that cheat** — phạt các công ty gian lận
- **protect their ratings** — bảo vệ điểm đánh giá của họ
- **responding politely to complaints** — phản hồi lịch sự trước khiếu nại

#174 Agree / Disagree · 294 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that influencer marketing misleads consumers. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Ordinary users who gain millions of followers are now paid by brands to recommend products, and many people think that influencer marketing misleads consumers. I agree to a large extent, since sponsorship is often hidden and claims are exaggerated, although some influencers are honest.

To begin with, influencer marketing can mislead consumers when sponsorship is hidden or claims are exaggerated. Followers trust influencers as friends, so undisclosed payments make recommendations look sincere. A beauty influencer who shows a new cream and says that it changed her skin in a week, for example, may have been paid and given the product free, and the improvement may result from lighting and filters. Posts that look like personal opinions are often scripted by advertising agencies. Young followers in particular may not realise that they are watching an advertisement, and they may buy products that they do not need or that do not work as promised. Some influencers promote financial schemes or supplements without any expertise, which can cause real damage.

However, not all influencers are dishonest. Many state clearly when a post is sponsored, test products before recommending them and refuse offers that do not fit their values. A cooking channel that explains why it uses a certain brand of knife, and mentions the free sample, for example, gives useful information. Disclosure rules protect buyers. Authorities can require labels such as "advert" or "paid partnership" on every sponsored post, punish false claims and educate young people on how influencer marketing works. Platforms can also build tools that mark paid content automatically. Consumers should treat recommendations as one source among many and read independent reviews.

In conclusion, I agree to a large extent that influencer marketing misleads consumers, but clear rules and critical attitudes can reduce the problem.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **gain millions of followers** — có hàng triệu người theo dõi
- **influencer marketing misleads consumers** — tiếp thị qua người ảnh hưởng gây hiểu lầm cho người tiêu dùng
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **sponsorship is hidden or claims are exaggerated** — việc tài trợ bị giấu hoặc tuyên bố bị phóng đại
- **Followers trust influencers as friends** — người theo dõi tin người ảnh hưởng như bạn bè
- **undisclosed payments make recommendations look sincere** — các khoản thanh toán không công khai khiến lời giới thiệu có vẻ chân thành
- **changed her skin in a week** — thay đổi làn da của cô trong một tuần
- **given the product free** — được tặng sản phẩm miễn phí
- **lighting and filters** — ánh sáng và bộ lọc
- **scripted by advertising agencies** — được các đại lý quảng cáo viết kịch bản
- **watching an advertisement** — đang xem một quảng cáo
- **products that they do not need** — những sản phẩm họ không cần
- **financial schemes or supplements without any expertise** — các kế hoạch tài chính hoặc thực phẩm bổ sung mà không có chuyên môn
- **state clearly when a post is sponsored** — nêu rõ khi bài đăng được tài trợ
- **test products before recommending them** — thử sản phẩm trước khi giới thiệu
- **the free sample** — mẫu thử miễn phí
- **Disclosure rules protect buyers** — quy tắc công khai bảo vệ người mua
- **"advert" or "paid partnership"** — "quảng cáo" hoặc "hợp tác trả phí"
- **punish false claims** — phạt các tuyên bố sai
- **mark paid content automatically** — tự động đánh dấu nội dung trả phí
- **independent reviews** — đánh giá độc lập

#187 Agree / Disagree · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that tackling poverty requires international cooperation. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Hunger, disease and lack of schooling affect hundreds of millions of people, and many people say that tackling poverty requires international cooperation. I agree with this view, since the causes of poverty cross borders, although each country must also act at home.

To begin with, tackling poverty needs international cooperation because its causes cross borders. Trade rules, debt, climate change and disease affect poor countries more than they can handle alone. A small farming nation whose crops are destroyed by drought caused by global warming, for example, cannot solve the problem by itself, and a pandemic spreads quickly from one country to another. Rich nations can offer aid, debt relief and technology, and international organisations can coordinate responses to disasters and share knowledge about successful programmes, such as vaccination and school meals. Fair trade rules that open markets to poor countries allow them to sell their goods and earn money. Without cooperation, poor countries may remain trapped.

However, each government must also take responsibility at home. Good governance, honest institutions, investment in education and health, and policies that encourage business are essential, and aid can be wasted where corruption is widespread. Countries such as South Korea and Vietnam improved living standards mainly through their own policies, with outside support playing a secondary role. Joint action multiplies local effort. Aid should therefore be targeted, transparent and designed together with the recipients, and it should aim to build skills and institutions that make dependency unnecessary. Individuals and charities also help through donations and volunteering.

In conclusion, I agree that tackling poverty requires international cooperation, but its success depends equally on responsible policies within each country.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Hunger, disease and lack of schooling** — đói, bệnh tật và thiếu giáo dục
- **Hundreds of millions of people** — hàng trăm triệu người
- **tackling poverty requires international cooperation** — xoá nghèo đòi hỏi sự hợp tác quốc tế
- **International cooperation** — hợp tác quốc tế
- **its causes cross borders** — nguyên nhân của nó vượt biên giới
- **Trade rules, debt, climate change and disease** — quy tắc thương mại, nợ, biến đổi khí hậu và dịch bệnh
- **handle alone** — tự xử lý
- **a small farming nation** — một quốc gia nông nghiệp nhỏ
- **drought caused by global warming** — hạn hán do nóng lên toàn cầu
- **a pandemic spreads quickly from one country to another** — đại dịch lan nhanh từ nước này sang nước khác
- **aid, debt relief and technology** — viện trợ, xoá nợ và công nghệ
- **coordinate responses to disasters** — điều phối ứng phó với thảm hoạ
- **vaccination and school meals** — tiêm chủng và bữa ăn học đường
- **Fair trade rules that open markets to poor countries** — quy tắc thương mại công bằng mở cửa thị trường cho các nước nghèo
- **Good governance, honest institutions** — quản trị tốt, thể chế liêm chính
- **aid can be wasted where corruption is widespread** — viện trợ có thể bị lãng phí nơi tham nhũng phổ biến
- **improved living standards mainly through their own policies** — cải thiện mức sống chủ yếu nhờ chính sách của chính họ
- **Joint action multiplies local effort** — hành động chung nhân lên nỗ lực địa phương
- **targeted, transparent and designed together with the recipients** — có mục tiêu, minh bạch và được thiết kế cùng với bên nhận
- **make dependency unnecessary** — khiến sự phụ thuộc trở nên không cần thiết

- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm

#194 Agree / Disagree · 301 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that subscription services are good value. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Music, films, software and even meals are now sold by monthly subscription, and many people think that subscription services are good value. I agree to some extent, since a fixed fee gives access to a large amount of content, although forgotten or overlapping plans waste money.

To begin with, subscriptions give good value for frequent users. A fixed fee unlocks large libraries or services. A family that pays a modest monthly sum for a streaming service, for example, can watch hundreds of films and series, whereas buying or renting the same titles individually would cost many times more. Music subscriptions give access to millions of songs on any device, and software subscriptions provide regular updates and storage. Costs are predictable and spread over the year, which helps with budgeting, and customers can cancel when their needs change, unlike a purchase. Delivery subscriptions can save money for those who shop often, since they remove charges on each order.

However, people often keep unused plans, pay for several overlapping services and own nothing at the end. A student who signs up for a free trial and forgets to cancel, for example, may pay for months without using the service. Many households subscribe to five or six streaming platforms, so that the total cost exceeds that of a single cable package, and prices often rise after the first year. Customers also lose access to their music or films as soon as they stop paying. Value depends on regular, conscious use. Consumers should review their subscriptions regularly, share family plans where allowed and cancel those that they rarely use. Companies should make cancelling simple and remind customers of renewal dates.

In conclusion, I agree to some extent that subscription services are good value, but only for those who use them regularly and manage them carefully.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Music, films, software and even meals are now sold by monthly subscription** — nhạc, phim, phần mềm và cả bữa ăn nay được bán theo đăng ký hằng tháng
- **subscription services are good value** — dịch vụ đăng ký đáng giá đồng tiền
- **A fixed fee unlocks large libraries or services** — phí cố định mở ra thư viện hoặc dịch vụ lớn
- **a modest monthly sum for a streaming service** — khoản tiền hằng tháng khiêm tốn cho dịch vụ phát trực tuyến
- **hundreds of films and series** — hàng trăm bộ phim và loạt phim
- **many times more** — gấp nhiều lần
- **millions of songs on any device** — hàng triệu bài hát trên mọi thiết bị
- **regular updates and storage** — cập nhật thường xuyên và dung lượng lưu trữ
- **Costs are predictable and spread over the year** — chi phí có thể dự đoán và dàn trải trong năm
- **cancel when their needs change** — huỷ khi nhu cầu thay đổi
- **remove charges on each order** — loại bỏ phí trên mỗi đơn hàng
- **keep unused plans** — giữ các gói không dùng
- **pay for several overlapping services** — trả tiền cho nhiều dịch vụ chồng chéo
- **own nothing at the end** — cuối cùng không sở hữu gì
- **a free trial and forgets to cancel** — dùng thử miễn phí và quên huỷ
- **five or six streaming platforms** — năm hoặc sáu nền tảng phát trực tuyến
- **prices often rise after the first year** — giá thường tăng sau năm đầu tiên
- **lose access** — mất quyền truy cập
- **regular, conscious use** — việc sử dụng đều đặn và có ý thức
- **review their subscriptions regularly** — rà soát các gói đăng ký của mình thường xuyên

- **make cancelling simple** — làm cho việc huỷ trở nên đơn giản

#316 Agree / Disagree · 289 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that fast delivery services harm local businesses. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Parcels arrive within hours, and vans from large platforms are seen in every street, so many people think that fast delivery services harm local businesses. I agree to some extent, since large platforms attract customers away from small shops, although the same services can help independent sellers.

To begin with, fast delivery services favour large platforms. Big companies with warehouses and low prices attract shoppers away from local shops. A bookshop that sells a novel for the full price, for example, loses a customer who can order it online at a discount and receive it the next morning. Large platforms can afford loss-making offers, free delivery and returns, which small shops cannot match. As more people expect speed and convenience, high-street shops lose footfall, and many have closed, leaving empty units and reducing local employment. Money spent on the platform often leaves the community, while a local shop keeps wages and profits in the area.

However, independent businesses can use the same networks to sell more widely. A small craft maker who lists products on a marketplace and uses a courier, for example, can reach customers hundreds of kilometres away, who would never have found her shop. Local restaurants, florists and bakeries use delivery apps to attract new clients, and many shops have launched their own websites. Local firms must adapt and offer service that platforms cannot. They can provide expert advice, personal attention, unique products and fast local delivery by their own staff, and they can emphasise community links. Councils can support them by reducing business charges and improving parking and the appearance of town centres.

In conclusion, I agree to some extent that fast delivery services harm local businesses, but those that adapt can benefit from them.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Parcels arrive within hours** — bưu kiện đến trong vài giờ
- **fast delivery services harm local businesses** — dịch vụ giao hàng nhanh gây hại cho doanh nghiệp địa phương
- **attract customers away from small shops** — hút khách hàng khỏi các cửa hàng nhỏ
- **warehouses and low prices attract shoppers away from local shops** — kho hàng và giá thấp hút người mua khỏi cửa hàng địa phương
- **sells a novel for the full price** — bán một cuốn tiểu thuyết với giá đầy đủ
- **order it online at a discount** — đặt mua trực tuyến với giá giảm
- **the next morning** — sáng hôm sau
- **loss-making offers, free delivery and returns** — ưu đãi chịu lỗ, giao hàng và trả hàng miễn phí
- **speed and convenience** — tốc độ và sự tiện lợi
- **lose footfall** — mất lượng khách đi bộ
- **empty units** — các mặt bằng bỏ trống
- **reducing local employment** — giảm việc làm địa phương
- **leaves the community** — rời khỏi cộng đồng
- **use the same networks to sell more widely** — dùng cùng mạng lưới để bán rộng rãi hơn
- **a small craft maker** — một người làm đồ thủ công nhỏ
- **lists products on a marketplace and uses a courier** — đăng sản phẩm lên sàn giao dịch và dùng dịch vụ chuyển phát
- **hundreds of kilometres away** — cách xa hàng trăm km
- **delivery apps** — ứng dụng giao hàng
- **adapt and offer service that platforms cannot** — thích nghi và cung cấp dịch vụ mà nền tảng không thể
- **expert advice, personal attention, unique products** — tư vấn chuyên gia, sự quan tâm cá nhân, sản phẩm độc đáo
- **improving parking** — cải thiện chỗ đỗ xe

#328 Agree / Disagree · 298 từ · AI 7.0

To what extent do you agree or disagree that brand loyalty is declining?

A generation ago, many families bought the same brand of soap, car or bank for decades, and some argue that brand loyalty is declining. I agree to a large extent, since shoppers compare prices and reviews easily, although strong brands still keep devoted customers.

To begin with, brand loyalty is declining in many categories because switching is easy. Online comparison, store brands and endless choice make changing simple. A shopper who sees on her phone that another brand of washing powder is cheaper and has better reviews, for example, can change within seconds, and a promotion can persuade her to try something new. Supermarkets sell their own labels that look similar to famous brands but cost less, and young consumers in particular are more willing to try new products recommended by friends or influencers. Subscriptions and apps allow customers to move from one service to another with a few taps, and economic uncertainty makes many people more careful with money.

However, strong brands with identity and loyalty programmes keep devoted customers. Some people remain committed to certain makers of phones, sports shoes or cars because the brand expresses who they are, and they accept higher prices. A person who has used the same smartphone system for ten years, for example, may stay with it because his photographs, apps and friends are connected to it. Airlines and shops use points and discounts to reward repeat purchases. Brands must earn loyalty through quality and service. Companies that treat customers well, respond quickly to complaints and keep improving their products are more likely to be trusted, and trust is more durable than a lower price.

In conclusion, I agree to a large extent that brand loyalty is declining, but companies with excellent products and a clear identity can still retain it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **brand loyalty is declining** — lòng trung thành với thương hiệu đang suy giảm
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **compare prices and reviews easily** — dễ dàng so sánh giá cả và đánh giá
- **Online comparison, store brands and endless choice make changing simple** — so sánh trực tuyến, nhãn hiệu riêng của cửa hàng và vô số lựa chọn khiến việc chuyển đổi trở nên đơn giản
- **another brand of washing powder is cheaper and has better reviews** — một nhãn bột giặt khác rẻ hơn và có đánh giá tốt hơn
- **change within seconds** — đổi trong vài giây
- **a promotion** — một đợt khuyến mãi
- **their own labels that look similar to famous brands but cost less** — nhãn riêng trông giống thương hiệu nổi tiếng nhưng rẻ hơn
- **recommended by friends or influencers** — được bạn bè hoặc người ảnh hưởng giới thiệu
- **move from one service to another with a few taps** — chuyển từ dịch vụ này sang dịch vụ khác chỉ với vài lần chạm
- **economic uncertainty** — bất ổn kinh tế
- **strong brands with identity and loyalty programmes** — thương hiệu mạnh có bản sắc và chương trình khách hàng thân thiết
- **expresses who they are** — thể hiện con người họ
- **accept higher prices** — chấp nhận giá cao hơn
- **the same smartphone system for ten years** — cùng một hệ điện thoại thông minh suốt mười năm
- **points and discounts to reward repeat purchases** — điểm và giảm giá để thưởng cho việc mua lặp lại
- **earn loyalty through quality and service** — giành được lòng trung thành bằng chất lượng và dịch vụ
- **respond quickly to complaints** — phản hồi nhanh với khiếu nại
- **trust is more durable than a lower price** — niềm tin bền vững hơn mức giá thấp hơn

#337 Agree / Disagree · 296 từ · AI 7.5

Some believe that international aid helps development. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

After earthquakes, famines and wars, rich countries send money, food and experts to poorer ones, and some believe that international aid helps development. I agree to a large extent, since aid can save lives and build services, although its success depends on how it is used.

To begin with, international aid helps development when it is targeted, transparent and builds local capacity. It saves lives in emergencies and funds clinics, schools and infrastructure. A vaccination programme financed from abroad, for example, can protect millions of children from diseases that poor governments cannot afford to fight, and a grant for rural roads or clean water allows farmers to sell their crops and families to stay healthy. Aid has contributed to major improvements in child survival and school enrolment over recent decades. Technical assistance also trains local teachers, doctors and engineers, who then continue the work without outside help.

However, corruption, dependency and poorly designed projects can waste money. If officials steal funds, or if donors give food that destroys local farmers' markets, aid may do more harm than good. Countries that receive aid for many years may stop building their own tax systems and rely on outside decisions. Some projects are chosen by donors without asking communities, and they fail when equipment breaks and no one can repair it. Aid should therefore support local ownership. Funds should be monitored and published, projects should be designed with the people who will use them, and money should go to areas such as health, education and infrastructure that create lasting benefits. Trade fairness and debt relief are also essential if poor countries are to grow.

In conclusion, I agree that international aid helps development to a large extent, provided that it is well targeted, transparent and designed with local people.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **After earthquakes, famines and wars** — sau động đất, nạn đói và chiến tranh
- **international aid helps development** — viện trợ quốc tế giúp thúc đẩy phát triển
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **targeted, transparent and builds local capacity** — có mục tiêu, minh bạch và xây dựng năng lực địa phương
- **saves lives in emergencies** — cứu sống con người trong các tình huống khẩn cấp
- **funds clinics, schools and infrastructure** — tài trợ phòng khám, trường học và cơ sở hạ tầng
- **A vaccination programme financed from abroad** — chương trình tiêm chủng được tài trợ từ nước ngoài
- **protect millions of children from diseases** — bảo vệ hàng triệu trẻ em khỏi bệnh tật
- **rural roads or clean water** — đường nông thôn hoặc nước sạch
- **stay healthy** — giữ sức khoẻ
- **child survival and school enrolment** — tỷ lệ sống sót của trẻ em và tỷ lệ nhập học
- **Technical assistance** — hỗ trợ kỹ thuật
- **local teachers, doctors and engineers** — giáo viên, bác sĩ và kỹ sư địa phương
- **corruption, dependency and poorly designed projects** — tham nhũng, sự phụ thuộc và các dự án thiết kế kém
- **steal funds** — biển thủ quỹ
- **destroys local farmers' markets** — phá huỷ thị trường của nông dân địa phương
- **more harm than good** — hại nhiều hơn lợi
- **building their own tax systems** — xây dựng hệ thống thuế của chính họ
- **chosen by donors without asking communities** — được nhà tài trợ chọn mà không hỏi cộng đồng
- **equipment breaks and no one can repair it** — thiết bị hỏng và không ai sửa được
- **local ownership** — quyền làm chủ của địa phương
- **monitored and published** — được giám sát và công bố
- **lasting benefits** — lợi ích lâu dài
- **debt relief** — xoá nợ

#490 Agree / Disagree · 299 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that quality control in manufacturing is insufficient. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Cars, food, medicines and electronics are recalled because of defects almost every week, and many people say that quality control in manufacturing is insufficient. I agree to some extent, since cost-cutting and long supply chains often outweigh inspection, although leading firms invest heavily in testing.

To begin with, quality control is insufficient where cost-cutting and long supply chains outweigh inspection. Recalls of cars, food and electronics show that defects pass checks when companies rush or outsource. A carmaker that discovers a faulty airbag only after millions of vehicles have been sold, for example, shows that its testing did not detect a problem that affected safety and cost lives. Parts are often made by dozens of suppliers in several countries, and a company may not know how each one is produced. Pressure to cut prices and to launch products quickly encourages shortcuts, and inspectors who are few in number cannot check every batch. Cheap goods sold online sometimes bypass inspection altogether.

However, many leading firms invest heavily in testing, and quality has improved in many industries. Automated cameras and sensors inspect products at high speed, and statistical methods identify problems early. A modern electronics factory, for example, may test every component and run each device through hours of stress tests before it leaves the line. Strict standards in aircraft and medicine are enforced and have produced very low failure rates. Inspection must be independent and continuous. Governments should require traceability of parts, fund independent testing, impose heavy penalties for hiding defects and protect employees who report problems, while companies should treat quality as a priority and not as a cost.

In conclusion, I agree to some extent that quality control in manufacturing is insufficient, particularly where cost pressure is strong, but good systems exist and can be spread more widely.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **recalled because of defects** — bị thu hồi vì lỗi
- **quality control in manufacturing is insufficient** — kiểm soát chất lượng trong sản xuất là chưa đủ
- **cost-cutting and long supply chains often outweigh inspection** — cắt giảm chi phí và chuỗi cung ứng dài thường lấn át việc kiểm tra
- **invest heavily in testing** — đầu tư mạnh vào kiểm nghiệm
- **supply chains** — chuỗi cung ứng
- **Recalls of cars, food and electronics** — việc thu hồi ô tô, thực phẩm và đồ điện tử
- **defects pass checks when companies rush or outsource** — lỗi lọt qua kiểm tra khi công ty vội vàng hoặc thuê ngoài
- **a faulty airbag** — một túi khí bị lỗi
- **millions of vehicles have been sold** — hàng triệu xe đã được bán
- **did not detect a problem that affected safety** — không phát hiện vấn đề ảnh hưởng đến an toàn
- **dozens of suppliers in several countries** — hàng chục nhà cung cấp ở nhiều quốc gia
- **Pressure to cut prices and to launch products quickly** — áp lực cắt giảm giá và ra mắt sản phẩm nhanh
- **shortcuts** — lối tắt
- **inspectors who are few in number** — các thanh tra viên số lượng ít
- **bypass inspection** — bỏ qua việc kiểm tra
- **Automated cameras and sensors inspect products at high speed** — camera và cảm biến tự động kiểm tra sản phẩm với tốc độ cao
- **statistical methods** — phương pháp thống kê
- **identify problems early** — phát hiện vấn đề sớm
- **test every component** — kiểm tra từng linh kiện
- **stress tests** — bài kiểm tra chịu tải
- **very low failure rates** — tỷ lệ hỏng hóc rất thấp
- **independent and continuous** — độc lập và liên tục

- **traceability of parts** — khả năng truy xuất nguồn gốc linh kiện
- **independent testing** — kiểm nghiệm độc lập
- **protect employees who report problems** — bảo vệ nhân viên báo cáo vấn đề

Causes / Solutions

#69 Causes / Solutions · 279 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of urban poverty? What solutions can be proposed?

In many cities, families live in crowded slums only a few kilometres from glittering towers, and this essay will discuss the causes of urban poverty and suggest solutions, focusing on work and housing.

To begin with, urban poverty comes from insecure work, costly housing and low skills. Migrants and low earners pay high rents for unstable jobs. A young man who arrives from the countryside without qualifications, for example, may find only casual work on building sites, earn too little to rent a decent room and end up sharing a crowded space with strangers. Without a secure contract, he has no sick pay or savings, and one illness can push the family into debt. Poor schools in deprived districts and the cost of transport to distant jobs add to the cycle. Cities also attract more workers than the formal economy can employ, so many are forced into the informal sector, where wages are low and conditions are unsafe.

In terms of solutions, affordable homes, vocational training, fair wages and services in poor districts help people to escape poverty. Governments can build social housing and improve slums with water, electricity and sanitation, while setting a minimum wage and enforcing contracts to protect workers. Training centres that teach construction, computing or care skills, for example, allow unemployed adults to find better jobs. Public transport links reduce the time and cost of getting to work, and microloans help small traders. Investment in schools and clinics in poor districts gives children better chances. Such policies replace dependency with opportunity.

In conclusion, urban poverty arises from insecure work, expensive housing and low skills, and it can be tackled through housing, training and decent wages.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **crowded slums only a few kilometres from glittering towers** — khu ổ chuột đông đúc chỉ cách các toà tháp lấp lánh vài km
- **causes of urban poverty** — nguyên nhân của nghèo đói đô thị
- **work and housing** — việc làm và nhà ở
- **insecure work, costly housing and low skills** — việc làm bấp bênh, nhà ở đắt đỏ và kỹ năng thấp
- **Migrants and low earners pay high rents for unstable jobs** — người nhập cư và người thu nhập thấp trả tiền thuê cao cho công việc bấp bênh
- **arrives from the countryside without qualifications** — từ nông thôn đến mà không có bằng cấp
- **casual work on building sites** — công việc thời vụ ở công trường xây dựng
- **sharing a crowded space with strangers** — ở chung không gian chật chội với người lạ
- **no sick pay or savings** — không có tiền ốm đau hay tiết kiệm
- **push the family into debt** — đẩy gia đình vào nợ nần
- **Poor schools in deprived districts** — trường học kém ở những khu thiếu thốn
- **the formal economy** — khu vực kinh tế chính thức
- **the informal sector** — khu vực phi chính thức
- **Affordable homes, vocational training, fair wages and services** — nhà ở giá phải chăng, đào tạo nghề, lương công bằng và dịch vụ
- **water, electricity and sanitation** — nước, điện và vệ sinh
- **a minimum wage** — mức lương tối thiểu
- **enforcing contracts** — thực thi hợp đồng
- **construction, computing or care skills** — kỹ năng xây dựng, tin học hoặc chăm sóc
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **microloans** — khoản vay vi mô
- **replace dependency with opportunity** — thay thế sự phụ thuộc bằng cơ hội

#202 Causes / Solutions · 263 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments promote ethical consumerism? Suggest practical measures.

Many shoppers say that they care about fair wages and the environment, yet few check how products are made, and this essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take to promote ethical consumerism, focusing on reliable information and on incentives.

To begin with, governments can promote ethical consumerism with clear labels, honest reporting and public purchasing. Shoppers need reliable information and incentives, so certified labels, supply-chain disclosure, tax breaks and ethical public procurement make responsible choices easier. A shopper who sees an official label that guarantees fair wages and low emissions, for example, can choose without reading long reports. Companies could be required to publish where their goods come from and under what conditions they are made, and false claims should be punished by fines. Governments are also major buyers of food, uniforms and furniture, so by preferring ethical suppliers, they create a large market and set an example.

In addition, authorities should reward responsible behaviour and educate the public. Lower taxes on certified fair-trade or recycled products make them cheaper than ordinary goods, while higher charges on products that cause serious harm discourage them. Schools can teach pupils about the effects of their purchases, and campaigns can show the real cost of cheap clothing or food. Equally important, governments can support small ethical producers with loans and training so that supply grows to meet demand. Over time, demand for fair and green products rises, which encourages more companies to change their methods.

In conclusion, clear labels, supply-chain transparency, fiscal incentives and education offer the most realistic way to promote ethical consumerism.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **care about fair wages and the environment** — quan tâm đến tiền lương công bằng và môi trường
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **promote ethical consumerism** — thúc đẩy tiêu dùng có đạo đức
- **reliable information and on incentives** — thông tin đáng tin cậy và các ưu đãi
- **clear labels, honest reporting and public purchasing** — nhãn rõ ràng, báo cáo trung thực và mua sắm công
- **certified labels, supply-chain disclosure, tax breaks and ethical public procurement** — nhãn được chứng nhận, công bố chuỗi cung ứng, ưu đãi thuế và mua sắm công đạo đức
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **an official label that guarantees fair wages and low emissions** — nhãn chính thức đảm bảo lương công bằng và phát thải thấp
- **publish where their goods come from** — công bố hàng hoá của họ đến từ đâu
- **false claims should be punished by fines** — các tuyên bố sai nên bị phạt tiền
- **major buyers of food, uniforms and furniture** — những người mua lớn thực phẩm, đồng phục và đồ nội thất
- **set an example** — làm gương
- **reward responsible behaviour** — thưởng cho hành vi có trách nhiệm
- **educate the public** — giáo dục công chúng
- **certified fair-trade or recycled products** — sản phẩm thương mại công bằng hoặc tái chế được chứng nhận
- **higher charges on products that cause serious harm** — phí cao hơn đối với sản phẩm gây hại nghiêm trọng
- **the real cost of cheap clothing or food** — chi phí thực của quần áo hoặc thực phẩm giá rẻ
- **small ethical producers with loans and training** — các nhà sản xuất nhỏ có đạo đức bằng khoản vay và đào tạo
- **supply grows to meet demand** — nguồn cung tăng để đáp ứng cầu
- **fiscal incentives** — ưu đãi tài khoá

#444 Causes / Solutions · 264 từ · AI 7.0

How can governments reduce corporate tax avoidance? Suggest practical measures.

Large companies often pay little tax even when they make huge profits, and this essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take to reduce corporate tax avoidance, focusing on closing loopholes and on international cooperation.

To begin with, governments can reduce tax avoidance by closing loopholes. Firms shift profits to low-tax countries through transfer pricing and shell companies, so reporting rules, a minimum rate and penalties limit it. A technology firm that books its profits in a small country where it has few staff, for example, can pay a rate far lower than a local shop. Countries can require companies to publish how much revenue, profit and tax they declare in every country, which makes artificial arrangements visible. Rules can also limit deductions for interest and royalties paid to related companies, and tax on profits can be linked to where sales and employees actually are. Strong penalties and well-trained auditors discourage cheating.

In addition, authorities must cooperate internationally. A single country that acts alone risks losing investment, so agreements are needed. A global minimum tax rate, which many countries have now accepted, removes the reward for moving profits to low-tax places. Countries can share information automatically about foreign accounts and companies, and help each other to collect unpaid tax. Public pressure also matters, since consumers and investors may avoid firms with a reputation for avoiding tax. Fairer revenue funds public services and reduces the burden on ordinary taxpayers, who currently pay more than their share.

In conclusion, closing loopholes together with international cooperation offers the most realistic way to reduce corporate tax avoidance.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **pay little tax even when they make huge profits** — đóng ít thuế dù đạt lợi nhuận khổng lồ
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **reduce corporate tax avoidance** — giảm việc doanh nghiệp tránh thuế
- **closing loopholes and on international cooperation** — bịt các kẽ hở và hợp tác quốc tế
- **Firms shift profits to low-tax countries** — các công ty chuyển lợi nhuận sang những nước có thuế thấp
- **transfer pricing and shell companies** — chuyển giá và công ty vỏ bọc
- **reporting rules, a minimum rate and penalties** — quy tắc báo cáo, mức thuế tối thiểu và hình phạt
- **books its profits in a small country where it has few staff** — ghi lợi nhuận ở một nước nhỏ nơi có ít nhân viên
- **a rate far lower than a local shop** — mức thuế thấp hơn nhiều so với một cửa hàng địa phương
- **publish how much revenue, profit and tax they declare in every country** — công bố doanh thu, lợi nhuận và thuế họ khai báo ở mỗi nước
- **artificial arrangements** — các sắp đặt giả tạo
- **limit deductions for interest and royalties paid to related companies** — hạn chế khấu trừ lãi và tiền bản quyền trả cho công ty liên quan
- **where sales and employees actually are** — nơi doanh số và nhân viên thực sự ở
- **well-trained auditors** — kiểm toán viên được đào tạo tốt
- **risks losing investment** — có nguy cơ mất đầu tư
- **A global minimum tax rate** — mức thuế tối thiểu toàn cầu
- **accepted** — được chấp nhận
- **removes the reward for moving profits** — loại bỏ phần thưởng của việc chuyển lợi nhuận
- **share information automatically about foreign accounts** — tự động chia sẻ thông tin về tài khoản nước ngoài
- **collect unpaid tax** — thu thuế chưa nộp
- **a reputation for avoiding tax** — tiếng xấu vì trốn tránh thuế
- **Fairer revenue funds public services** — nguồn thu công bằng hơn tài trợ dịch vụ công
- **International cooperation** — hợp tác quốc tế

#484 Causes / Solutions · 283 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments support creative industries during economic downturns? Suggest practical measures.

When recessions arrive, theatres, design studios, publishers and film crews often lose customers first, and this essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take to support creative industries during economic downturns, focusing on emergency finance and on helping the sector to adapt.

To begin with, governments can protect creative industries with emergency funds, tax relief and commissions. Artists and studios rely on irregular income and discretionary spending, so grants, loans, public contracts and help with digital and foreign markets keep talent and skills alive. A theatre company that cannot sell tickets during a crisis, for example, can survive with a government grant that pays rent and wages until audiences return. Temporary reductions in sales tax and business charges leave more money in the sector, while loans on favourable terms prevent firms from collapsing. Governments can also commission murals, films, music and design for public buildings and campaigns, which gives work to many freelancers.

In addition, authorities should help the sector to adapt and to grow. Training in digital skills allows creators to sell online, and export agencies can help studios to reach foreign markets where demand may be stronger. Shared workspaces at low rent and funds for new ideas encourage start-ups, and income support for self-employed artists prevents them from leaving the profession. Equally important, protecting copyright ensures that creators are paid when their work is used. The sector recovers faster and contributes to growth, since creative industries employ many people and attract tourists, and a recession is a time to preserve skills that would take years to rebuild.

In conclusion, emergency finance together with support for adaptation and export offers the most realistic way to protect creative industries in a downturn.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **theatres, design studios, publishers and film crews** — nhà hát, studio thiết kế, nhà xuất bản và đoàn làm phim
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **support creative industries during economic downturns** — hỗ trợ các ngành sáng tạo trong thời kỳ kinh tế suy thoái
- **emergency finance** — tài chính khẩn cấp
- **emergency funds, tax relief and commissions** — quỹ khẩn cấp, giảm thuế và hợp đồng đặt hàng
- **irregular income and discretionary spending** — thu nhập thất thường và chi tiêu tuỳ ý
- **grants, loans, public contracts** — trợ cấp, khoản vay, hợp đồng công
- **help with digital and foreign markets** — hỗ trợ về thị trường số và thị trường nước ngoài
- **keep talent and skills alive** — giữ cho tài năng và kỹ năng không mai một
- **cannot sell tickets during a crisis** — không thể bán vé trong thời kỳ khủng hoảng
- **pays rent and wages until audiences return** — trả tiền thuê và lương cho đến khi khán giả quay lại
- **Temporary reductions in sales tax and business charges** — giảm tạm thời thuế bán hàng và phí kinh doanh
- **loans on favourable terms** — khoản vay với điều kiện ưu đãi
- **murals, films, music and design** — tranh tường, phim, âm nhạc và thiết kế
- **Training in digital skills** — đào tạo kỹ năng số
- **export agencies** — cơ quan xúc tiến xuất khẩu
- **Shared workspaces at low rent** — không gian làm việc chung với giá thuê thấp
- **income support for self-employed artists** — hỗ trợ thu nhập cho nghệ sĩ tự do
- **protecting copyright** — bảo vệ bản quyền
- **attract tourists** — thu hút du khách
- **preserve skills that would take years to rebuild** — bảo tồn những kỹ năng phải mất nhiều năm mới xây dựng lại được

Extent

#113 Extent · 278 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think online shopping will change retail in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Parcels arrive at doors every day, and many shopping streets have empty units, so the question is how far online shopping will change retail within twenty years. I believe that it will transform retail greatly, although physical shops will survive as experience centres.

To begin with, convenience, price comparison and home delivery draw customers online. Shoppers can buy anything at any hour, compare prices in seconds and have the goods brought to their door. A busy parent who orders groceries, clothes and a birthday present in one evening, for example, saves hours of travel and queues. Companies without shops can sell at lower prices, because they save on rent and staff, and new technologies such as virtual fitting rooms and faster delivery will make online purchases even more attractive. Many chains have already closed branches, and the share of internet sales continues to rise each year, especially among young consumers.

However, people still want to try clothes, see goods and enjoy shopping as a social activity. Some products, such as fresh food, furniture and luxury items, are better judged in person, and returns of unsuitable goods are a nuisance and a cost. Shops that offer expert advice, comfortable surroundings and events can attract visitors, and many online companies are opening physical stores to build trust. Retailers will therefore combine online and in-store services, for example by letting customers order on a website and collect goods at the shop. The high street will become smaller but more focused on experience, while delivery and warehouses will expand.

In conclusion, online shopping will change retail to a very large extent over the next twenty years, but physical shops will not disappear.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Parcels arrive at doors every day** — bưu kiện đến tận cửa mỗi ngày
- **empty units** — các mặt bằng bỏ trống
- **online shopping will change retail** — mua sắm trực tuyến sẽ thay đổi ngành bán lẻ
- **experience centres** — trung tâm trải nghiệm
- **convenience, price comparison and home delivery** — sự tiện lợi, so sánh giá và giao hàng tận nhà
- **at any hour** — vào bất kỳ giờ nào
- **compare prices in seconds** — so sánh giá trong vài giây
- **goods brought to their door** — hàng hoá được mang đến tận cửa
- **orders groceries, clothes and a birthday present in one evening** — đặt thực phẩm, quần áo và quà sinh nhật trong một buổi tối
- **saves hours of travel and queues** — tiết kiệm hàng giờ đi lại và xếp hàng
- **save on rent and staff** — tiết kiệm tiền thuê và nhân viên
- **virtual fitting rooms** — phòng thử đồ ảo
- **closed branches** — đóng chi nhánh
- **the share of internet sales continues to rise** — tỷ trọng doanh số bán qua internet tiếp tục tăng
- **try clothes, see goods and enjoy shopping as a social activity** — thử quần áo, xem hàng và tận hưởng việc mua sắm như một hoạt động xã hội
- **fresh food, furniture and luxury items** — thực phẩm tươi, đồ nội thất và hàng xa xỉ
- **returns of unsuitable goods** — việc trả lại hàng không phù hợp
- **expert advice, comfortable surroundings and events** — lời tư vấn chuyên gia, không gian thoải mái và sự kiện
- **build trust** — xây dựng lòng tin
- **order on a website and collect goods at the shop** — đặt hàng trên website và nhận hàng tại cửa hàng
- **warehouses will expand** — các kho hàng sẽ mở rộng
- **disappear** — biến mất

#150 Extent · 291 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that lowering taxes stimulates the economy. To what extent do you agree?

Governments facing weak growth often promise tax cuts, and some argue that lowering taxes stimulates the economy. I agree to a limited extent, since tax cuts can encourage spending and investment, but the effect depends on who benefits and how the lost revenue is replaced.

To begin with, lower taxes can stimulate spending and investment. Households and firms with more money may spend or hire. A family that pays less income tax, for example, may buy a car or home improvements, which creates demand for local businesses and jobs. Lower taxes on company profits can encourage firms to expand, buy equipment or start new projects, and a lower tax rate can attract foreign investors. In a recession, when demand is weak, a temporary reduction in sales tax can persuade consumers to buy sooner, giving the economy a quick boost. Lower taxes on work may also encourage people to take jobs or to work longer hours.

However, the effect depends on who benefits and on how deficits are financed. Wealthy savers may not spend the extra money, and lost revenue can mean cuts in services such as schools and hospitals or higher government debt, which must be repaid later. A broad cut that mainly helps high earners, for example, may raise inequality without much increase in demand. Targeted cuts work better than broad ones: tax relief for low and middle earners, who spend most of what they receive, and incentives for investment in productive equipment give more benefit per unit of lost revenue. Evidence from different countries shows mixed results, so tax policy should be judged by its results.

In conclusion, lowering taxes stimulates the economy only to a limited extent, and governments should design cuts carefully and keep public finances sustainable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **weak growth** — tăng trưởng yếu
- **lowering taxes stimulates the economy** — giảm thuế kích thích nền kinh tế
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **lost revenue** — nguồn thu bị mất
- **stimulate spending and investment** — kích thích chi tiêu và đầu tư
- **Households and firms with more money may spend or hire** — hộ gia đình và doanh nghiệp có nhiều tiền hơn có thể chi tiêu hoặc thuê người
- **pays less income tax** — đóng ít thuế thu nhập hơn
- **home improvements** — cải tạo nhà cửa
- **creates demand for local businesses and jobs** — tạo nhu cầu cho doanh nghiệp và việc làm địa phương
- **expand, buy equipment or start new projects** — mở rộng, mua thiết bị hoặc bắt đầu dự án mới
- **attract foreign investors** — thu hút nhà đầu tư nước ngoài
- **a temporary reduction in sales tax** — giảm tạm thời thuế bán hàng
- **a quick boost** — cú hích nhanh
- **Wealthy savers may not spend the extra money** — người giàu tiết kiệm có thể không chi số tiền thêm
- **cuts in services** — cắt giảm dịch vụ
- **higher government debt** — nợ chính phủ cao hơn
- **A broad cut that mainly helps high earners** — đợt cắt giảm rộng chủ yếu có lợi cho người thu nhập cao
- **raise inequality** — làm tăng bất bình đẳng
- **Targeted cuts work better than broad ones** — cắt giảm có mục tiêu hiệu quả hơn cắt giảm đại trà
- **low and middle earners** — người thu nhập thấp và trung bình
- **public finances sustainable** — tài chính công bền vững

#160 Extent · 282 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should governments support small businesses? Give reasons for your answer.

Corner shops, workshops and family restaurants make up most of the businesses in many countries, and the question is to what extent governments should support small businesses. I agree to a large extent, since small firms create jobs and local prosperity, although support should not become permanent dependency.

To begin with, governments should support small businesses because they create most jobs and local prosperity. Small firms provide a large share of employment and innovation, yet they face higher borrowing costs and more paperwork than large companies. A baker who wants to buy a second oven, for example, may be refused a loan because the bank sees the risk as too high, and she may spend days filling in tax forms that large firms handle with a department. Small businesses keep money in local communities, create opportunities for young people and diversify the economy so that it depends less on a few giant employers. In rural areas and poorer districts, they are often the only source of work.

However, support should aim to build resilience, not permanent dependency. If firms receive endless subsidies, they may stay inefficient and avoid improvement, and taxpayers pay for businesses that cannot survive. Support should therefore be targeted and temporary: guarantees for loans, simpler registration and accounting, advice, training and public contracts that are open to small suppliers. Governments should also remove barriers such as complicated regulations rather than only giving money. Evaluation of programmes helps to make sure that public funds produce results. When help encourages firms to grow and compete, the whole economy benefits.

In conclusion, I agree that governments should support small businesses to a large extent, provided that assistance is targeted and encourages independence.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Corner shops, workshops and family restaurants** — cửa hàng góc phố, xưởng và nhà hàng gia đình
- **support small businesses** — hỗ trợ doanh nghiệp nhỏ
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **should not become permanent** — không nên thành vĩnh viễn
- **create most jobs and local prosperity** — tạo ra hầu hết việc làm và sự thịnh vượng địa phương
- **a large share of employment and innovation** — phần lớn việc làm và đổi mới
- **higher borrowing costs and more paperwork** — chi phí vay cao hơn và nhiều thủ tục giấy tờ hơn
- **buy a second oven** — mua lò nướng thứ hai
- **refused a loan** — bị từ chối cho vay
- **the risk as too high** — rủi ro quá cao
- **tax forms that large firms handle with a department** — biểu mẫu thuế mà các công ty lớn xử lý bằng cả một bộ phận
- **keep money in local communities** — giữ tiền trong cộng đồng địa phương
- **opportunities for young people** — cơ hội cho người trẻ
- **depends less on a few giant employers** — ít phụ thuộc vào một vài nhà tuyển dụng khổng lồ
- **the only source of work** — nguồn việc làm duy nhất
- **build resilience, not permanent dependency** — xây dựng khả năng chống chịu chứ không phải sự phụ thuộc lâu dài
- **endless subsidies** — trợ cấp vô tận
- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **guarantees for loans, simpler registration and accounting** — bảo lãnh khoản vay, đăng ký và kế toán đơn giản hơn
- **public contracts that are open to small suppliers** — hợp đồng công mở cho nhà cung cấp nhỏ
- **complicated regulations** — quy định phức tạp
- **public funds produce results** — tiền công mang lại kết quả

#200 Extent · 282 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should tax revenue be used for cultural projects? Give reasons for your answer.

Governments collect taxes mainly to pay for hospitals, schools, defence and roads, yet they also finance museums, orchestras, festivals and historic buildings, and the question is to what extent tax revenue should be used for cultural projects. I believe that some of it should, but only after essential services are secure.

To begin with, culture deserves a share of public money because it preserves identity and benefits society. Museums, heritage sites and arts education preserve identity and attract tourists. A city that restores its old town and supports a theatre, for example, gains visitors who spend money in hotels and shops, and residents feel pride in their history. Culture also enriches education, since children who learn music, drama or art develop creativity and confidence, and free access to galleries allows poorer families to enjoy it. Private markets alone may not support activities with small audiences, such as classical music or traditional crafts, which would disappear without help.

However, hospitals, schools and housing meet more urgent needs, so culture should receive a limited, accountable share. A government that spends millions on a grand opera house while clinics lack equipment, for example, would be criticised for its priorities. Culture projects should therefore be chosen carefully, with clear aims and regular reports on costs and results. Partnerships with private donors stretch the budget: companies and individuals can sponsor exhibitions, and ticket sales and shops can raise part of the cost. Local communities should also have a say in which projects are funded, so that the money benefits ordinary people and not only an educated minority.

In conclusion, tax revenue should be used for cultural projects to a moderate extent, after essential services have been funded.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **hospitals, schools, defence and roads** — bệnh viện, trường học, quốc phòng và đường sá
- **museums, orchestras, festivals and historic buildings** — bảo tàng, dàn nhạc, lễ hội và công trình lịch sử
- **tax revenue should be used for cultural projects** — nguồn thu thuế nên được dùng cho các dự án văn hoá
- **essential services** — dịch vụ thiết yếu
- **public money** — tiền công
- **preserves identity and benefits society** — bảo tồn bản sắc và có lợi cho xã hội
- **Museums, heritage sites and arts education** — bảo tàng, di sản và giáo dục nghệ thuật
- **attract tourists** — thu hút du khách
- **restores its old town** — trùng tu khu phố cổ
- **supports a theatre** — hỗ trợ một nhà hát
- **spend money in hotels and shops** — chi tiền ở khách sạn và cửa hàng
- **pride in their history** — niềm tự hào về lịch sử của họ
- **develop creativity and confidence** — phát triển sự sáng tạo và sự tự tin
- **free access to galleries** — vào cửa miễn phí các phòng tranh
- **classical music or traditional crafts** — nhạc cổ điển hoặc nghề thủ công truyền thống
- **would disappear without help** — sẽ biến mất nếu không có sự giúp đỡ
- **hospitals, schools and housing meet more urgent needs** — bệnh viện, trường học và nhà ở đáp ứng nhu cầu cấp bách hơn
- **limited, accountable share** — phần có hạn và có trách nhiệm giải trình
- **a grand opera house while clinics lack equipment** — một nhà hát opera lớn trong khi các phòng khám thiếu thiết bị
- **regular reports on costs and results** — báo cáo định kỳ về chi phí và kết quả
- **Partnerships with private donors** — hợp tác với nhà tài trợ tư nhân
- **sponsor exhibitions** — tài trợ các cuộc triển lãm
- **an educated minority** — một thiểu số có học thức

#233 Extent · 299 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think 3D printing will change manufacturing in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Machines that build objects layer by layer from plastic, metal or even concrete are already used in hospitals, factories and homes, and the question is how far 3D printing will change manufacturing within twenty years. I believe that it will transform some areas greatly, although it will not replace mass production.

To begin with, 3D printing will transform prototypes, custom parts and spare supplies. It makes complex or personalised items quickly and cuts waste and transport. An engineer who wants to test a new design, for example, can print a model overnight instead of waiting weeks for a factory to make a mould. Dentists already print crowns and hearing-aid shells that fit each patient exactly, and surgeons use printed models to plan operations. Remote places such as ships, mines and space stations can print spare parts on the spot rather than carry large stocks. Because the printer adds material rather than cutting it away, less is wasted, and products can be designed in shapes that were once impossible.

However, 3D printing is slow and costly for large production runs and limited in materials. A car manufacturer that needs a million identical door handles, for example, can make them far more cheaply by casting or stamping. Printed objects are often weaker or rougher than those made by traditional methods, and only a limited range of plastics and metals can be used. Quality control and intellectual property also raise problems, since anyone with a file can copy a product. It will complement factories rather than replace them. In twenty years, printers will be common in workshops, hospitals and some homes, but most everyday goods will still come from conventional factories.

In conclusion, 3D printing will change manufacturing to a considerable extent in certain areas, but it will not replace mass production.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Machines that build objects layer by layer** — máy xây dựng vật thể từng lớp một
- **3D printing will change manufacturing** — in 3D sẽ thay đổi sản xuất
- **mass production** — sản xuất hàng loạt
- **prototypes, custom parts and spare supplies** — nguyên mẫu, linh kiện tuỳ chỉnh và đồ dự phòng
- **complex or personalised items quickly** — các sản phẩm phức tạp hoặc cá nhân hoá một cách nhanh chóng
- **cuts waste and transport** — giảm lãng phí và vận chuyển
- **test a new design** — thử nghiệm một thiết kế mới
- **print a model overnight** — in một mô hình qua đêm
- **waiting weeks for a factory to make a mould** — chờ hàng tuần để nhà máy làm khuôn
- **crowns and hearing-aid shells** — mão răng và vỏ máy trợ thính
- **fit each patient exactly** — vừa khít với từng bệnh nhân
- **plan operations** — lên kế hoạch phẫu thuật
- **ships, mines and space stations** — tàu biển, mỏ và trạm vũ trụ
- **print spare parts on the spot** — in phụ tùng thay thế tại chỗ
- **adds material rather than cutting it away** — thêm vật liệu thay vì cắt bỏ nó
- **shapes that were once impossible** — những hình dạng từng là bất khả thi
- **slow and costly for large production runs** — chậm và tốn kém khi sản xuất số lượng lớn
- **a million identical door handles** — một triệu tay nắm cửa giống hệt nhau
- **more cheaply** — rẻ hơn
- **casting or stamping** — đúc hoặc dập
- **intellectual property** — sở hữu trí tuệ
- **complement factories rather than replace them** — bổ sung chứ không thay thế nhà máy
- **to a considerable extent** — ở mức độ đáng kể

#392 Extent · 282 từ · AI 8.0

Some argue that stricter consumer protection laws improve safety. To what extent do you agree?

Defective toys, contaminated food and faulty electrical goods cause injuries every year, and some argue that stricter consumer protection laws improve safety. I agree to a large extent, since standards and penalties make firms avoid dangerous products, although enforcement matters as much as the laws themselves.

To begin with, stricter consumer protection laws improve safety by setting standards and punishing negligence. Mandatory testing, recalls and heavy fines force firms to avoid dangerous products. A toy manufacturer that must prove its products are free of poisonous paint before selling them, for example, will check its suppliers carefully, since a failure could lead to a ban and a costly lawsuit. Clear labelling of ingredients, allergens and warnings helps buyers to make safe choices, and rules on cooling and hygiene in food production reduce poisoning. Countries with strong consumer agencies, such as those in northern Europe, have lower rates of accidents from household products. When dangerous goods are found, laws allow quick recalls that protect others.

However, compliance costs and weak enforcement can reduce the benefit. Small companies may find the paperwork and testing expensive, which can raise prices or reduce the variety of products, and rules that are not checked are ignored. Online marketplaces make it easy to import cheap goods that avoid inspection. Strong laws with effective inspection protect the public. Governments should fund inspectors and laboratories, hold online platforms responsible for unsafe items sold through them, and cooperate internationally to track dangerous products. Consumers can also help by reporting problems and by reading labels carefully.

In conclusion, I agree to a large extent that stricter consumer protection laws improve safety, provided that they are enforced and designed with small businesses in mind.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Defective toys, contaminated food and faulty electrical goods** — đồ chơi lỗi, thực phẩm nhiễm bẩn và đồ điện hỏng
- **stricter consumer protection laws improve safety** — luật bảo vệ người tiêu dùng nghiêm ngặt hơn cải thiện an toàn
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **dangerous** — nguy hiểm
- **setting standards and punishing negligence** — đặt ra tiêu chuẩn và trừng phạt sự cẩu thả
- **Mandatory testing, recalls and heavy fines** — kiểm nghiệm bắt buộc, thu hồi sản phẩm và phạt nặng
- **free of poisonous paint** — không có sơn độc
- **check its suppliers carefully** — kiểm tra nhà cung cấp cẩn thận
- **a ban and a costly lawsuit** — lệnh cấm và vụ kiện tốn kém
- **Clear labelling of ingredients, allergens and warnings** — nhãn rõ ràng về thành phần, chất gây dị ứng và cảnh báo
- **cooling and hygiene in food production** — làm lạnh và vệ sinh trong sản xuất thực phẩm
- **strong consumer agencies** — các cơ quan bảo vệ người tiêu dùng mạnh
- **northern Europe** — Bắc Âu
- **accidents from household products** — tai nạn do sản phẩm gia dụng
- **quick recalls** — thu hồi nhanh chóng
- **compliance costs and weak enforcement** — chi phí tuân thủ và thực thi yếu
- **paperwork and testing expensive** — thủ tục giấy tờ và kiểm nghiệm tốn kém
- **Online marketplaces make it easy to import cheap goods that avoid inspection** — sàn thương mại điện tử giúp dễ nhập hàng rẻ né tránh kiểm tra
- **fund inspectors and laboratories** — tài trợ cho thanh tra viên và phòng thí nghiệm
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **unsafe items sold through them** — các mặt hàng không an toàn được bán qua chúng

- **track dangerous products** — theo dõi sản phẩm nguy hiểm
- **reading labels carefully** — đọc nhãn cẩn thận

#395 Extent · 297 từ · AI 7.0

How far do you think digital currencies will affect global finance in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Bitcoin and other digital currencies have grown from a niche idea into assets worth trillions, and the question is how far they will affect global finance within twenty years. I believe that they will change payments and settlement considerably, although they will not replace traditional money.

To begin with, digital currencies will change payments. They can make cross-border transfers cheap and widen access to finance. A migrant worker who sends money to her family, for example, may pay a small fee and see it arrive within minutes, instead of paying high commissions and waiting for days. Millions of people in countries with weak banking systems already use mobile money, and digital wallets allow them to save, borrow and trade without a bank account. Many central banks are developing their own digital currencies, which would allow instant, low-cost payments between businesses and individuals and give governments better information about the economy. Smart contracts could automate settlement in securities and trade finance.

However, price swings, fraud and the risk to monetary control mean central banks are cautious. The value of some cryptocurrencies has fallen by half in weeks, which makes them unreliable for everyday use, and scams and thefts from exchanges have cost investors billions. If large amounts of money moved outside the banking system, authorities would find it harder to manage interest rates and to stop money laundering. State-backed digital money is more likely than private coins to dominate. Governments will probably regulate private coins strictly, require exchanges to follow banking rules and issue their own digital currencies to keep control of the monetary system.

In conclusion, digital currencies will affect global finance to a considerable extent over the next twenty years, mainly through faster payments and official digital money, but they are unlikely to replace existing currencies.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Bitcoin and other digital currencies** — Bitcoin và các loại tiền kỹ thuật số khác
- **a niche idea into assets worth trillions** — từ một ý tưởng ngách thành tài sản trị giá hàng nghìn tỷ
- **change payments and settlement** — thay đổi thanh toán và bù trừ
- **cross-border transfers cheap and widen access to finance** — chuyển khoản xuyên biên giới rẻ và mở rộng khả năng tiếp cận tài chính
- **sends money to her family** — gửi tiền cho gia đình
- **arrive within minutes** — đến nơi trong vài phút
- **high commissions and waiting for days** — hoa hồng cao và chờ nhiều ngày
- **weak banking systems** — hệ thống ngân hàng yếu
- **mobile money** — tiền di động
- **save, borrow and trade without a bank account** — tiết kiệm, vay và giao dịch mà không cần tài khoản ngân hàng
- **central banks are developing their own digital currencies** — các ngân hàng trung ương đang phát triển tiền kỹ thuật số của riêng mình
- **instant, low-cost payments** — thanh toán tức thì, chi phí thấp
- **Smart contracts could automate settlement in securities** — hợp đồng thông minh có thể tự động hoá việc thanh toán bù trừ chứng khoán
- **price swings, fraud and the risk to monetary control** — biến động giá, gian lận và rủi ro đối với việc kiểm soát tiền tệ
- **fallen by half in weeks** — giảm một nửa trong vài tuần
- **unreliable** — không đáng tin cậy
- **thefts from exchanges** — các vụ trộm từ sàn giao dịch
- **manage interest rates and to stop money laundering** — quản lý lãi suất và ngăn chặn rửa tiền
- **State-backed digital money** — tiền kỹ thuật số do nhà nước bảo chứng
- **private coins** — các đồng tiền tư nhân

- **digital currencies will affect global finance** — tiền kỹ thuật số sẽ ảnh hưởng đến tài chính toàn cầu
- **to a considerable extent** — ở mức độ đáng kể

#422 Extent · 299 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent should governments intervene in housing markets to control prices? Give reasons for your answer.

In many cities, ordinary workers cannot afford to buy or rent near their jobs, and the question is to what extent governments should intervene in housing markets to control prices. I believe that governments should intervene to a considerable extent, but they should favour measures that increase supply over rigid price controls.

To begin with, markets alone leave many people priced out, so some intervention is justified. Housing is a basic need, and when prices rise faster than wages, families are forced to spend a large share of their income on rent or leave the city. Social housing, planning reform and taxes on speculation help. A city that builds thousands of affordable flats on public land, for example, offers low-income families a secure home and also reduces pressure on private rents. Governments can simplify planning rules so that more homes are built, tax empty properties and second homes, and give housing allowances to those with the lowest incomes. Without such action, housing may become a privilege for the wealthy.

However, rigid rent caps can discourage building. If the law holds rents below market levels, landlords may stop maintaining properties or sell them, and developers may build fewer homes, which makes shortages worse. Price controls also benefit the people who already have a flat, not those who are searching. Targeted intervention keeps homes affordable. The best approach combines increased supply, which brings prices down over time, with temporary protection for tenants against sudden large rises, and support for those who cannot afford even moderate rents. Governments should also monitor the market and adjust policy when conditions change, since housing problems differ between cities.

In conclusion, governments should intervene in housing markets to a considerable extent, mainly by increasing supply and protecting vulnerable households, rather than by imposing strict price controls.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **ordinary workers cannot afford to buy or rent near their jobs** — người lao động bình thường không đủ khả năng mua hay thuê nhà gần nơi làm việc
- **intervene in housing markets to control prices** — can thiệp vào thị trường nhà ở để kiểm soát giá
- **to a considerable extent** — ở mức độ đáng kể
- **markets alone leave many people priced out** — chỉ riêng thị trường khiến nhiều người không đủ khả năng mua
- **prices rise faster than wages** — giá tăng nhanh hơn tiền lương
- **a large share of their income on rent** — một phần lớn thu nhập vào tiền thuê nhà
- **Social housing, planning reform and taxes on speculation** — nhà ở xã hội, cải cách quy hoạch và thuế đầu cơ
- **builds thousands of affordable flats on public land** — xây hàng nghìn căn hộ giá phải chăng trên đất công
- **low-income families** — gia đình thu nhập thấp
- **a secure home** — một ngôi nhà an toàn
- **pressure on private rents** — áp lực lên giá thuê tư nhân
- **simplify planning rules** — đơn giản hoá quy tắc quy hoạch
- **tax empty properties and second homes** — đánh thuế bất động sản bỏ trống và nhà thứ hai
- **housing allowances** — trợ cấp nhà ở
- **the lowest incomes** — thu nhập thấp nhất
- **a privilege for the wealthy** — đặc quyền của người giàu
- **rigid rent caps can discourage building** — trần giá thuê cứng nhắc có thể làm nản việc xây dựng
- **stop maintaining properties or sell them** — ngừng bảo trì tài sản hoặc bán chúng
- **shortages worse** — thiếu hụt tệ hơn
- **benefit the people who already have a flat** — có lợi cho những người đã có căn hộ
- **Targeted intervention keeps homes affordable** — can thiệp có mục tiêu giữ cho nhà ở giá phải chăng

- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **protection for tenants against sudden large rises** — bảo vệ người thuê khỏi những đợt tăng giá lớn đột ngột
- **monitor the market** — giám sát thị trường
- **vulnerable** — dễ bị tổn thương

#432 Extent · 286 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that higher taxes on luxury goods reduce inequality. To what extent do you agree?

Yachts, designer handbags and sports cars are bought by only a few, and some argue that higher taxes on luxury goods reduce inequality. I agree only to a limited extent, since such taxes raise some money from the wealthy, but wealth is better addressed through income and property taxes.

To begin with, luxury taxes can make a small contribution. They raise some revenue from wealthy buyers and make the tax system look fairer. A tax of twenty per cent on a yacht, for example, falls almost entirely on people who have plenty of money and who can afford to pay it, and the proceeds can fund schools or healthcare that benefit poorer people. Because luxury goods are not necessities, taxing them does not harm the poor. Higher prices may also discourage showy consumption, which can reduce the social pressure that people feel to compete in spending. Several countries have used such taxes on cars, jewellery and watches.

However, the amounts are small, buyers can purchase abroad and jobs in luxury industries may suffer. The wealthiest people can buy a yacht in another country or register it elsewhere, and the revenue from luxury items is tiny compared with income tax or property tax. Factories that produce fine furniture or jewellery may lose orders and dismiss craft workers. Broader progressive taxation is more effective. Higher rates of income tax for top earners, taxes on inheritance and capital gains, and a modest annual tax on very large fortunes raise far more money, while spending on education, health care and housing for poorer families addresses inequality directly.

In conclusion, higher taxes on luxury goods reduce inequality only to a limited extent, and governments should rely mainly on wider progressive taxation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Yachts, designer handbags and sports cars** — du thuyền, túi xách hàng hiệu và xe thể thao
- **higher taxes on luxury goods reduce inequality** — thuế cao hơn đối với hàng xa xỉ giảm bất bình đẳng
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **raise some revenue from wealthy buyers** — thu một phần nguồn thu từ người mua giàu có
- **make the tax system look fairer** — làm hệ thống thuế trông công bằng hơn
- **twenty per cent on a yacht** — hai mươi phần trăm đối với một chiếc du thuyền
- **fund schools or healthcare** — tài trợ cho trường học hoặc chăm sóc y tế
- **luxury goods are not necessities** — hàng xa xỉ không phải nhu yếu phẩm
- **discourage showy consumption** — làm nản việc tiêu dùng phô trương
- **cars, jewellery and watches** — xe hơi, trang sức và đồng hồ
- **the amounts are small, buyers can purchase abroad** — số tiền nhỏ, người mua có thể mua ở nước ngoài
- **register it elsewhere** — đăng ký ở nơi khác
- **tiny compared with income tax or property tax** — rất nhỏ so với thuế thu nhập hoặc thuế tài sản
- **fine furniture or jewellery** — đồ nội thất cao cấp hoặc trang sức
- **craft workers** — thợ thủ công
- **Broader progressive taxation is more effective** — thuế luỹ tiến rộng hơn thì hiệu quả hơn
- **Higher rates of income tax for top earners** — thuế suất thu nhập cao hơn cho người có thu nhập cao nhất
- **inheritance and capital gains** — thừa kế và lãi vốn
- **a modest annual tax on very large fortunes** — thuế hằng năm vừa phải đánh vào những khối tài sản rất lớn
- **housing for poorer families** — nhà ở cho các gia đình nghèo hơn

#462 Extent · 289 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should governments subsidize electric vehicle purchases? Give reasons for your answer.

Sales of electric cars are growing, but they still cost more than petrol models, and the question is to what extent governments should subsidise their purchase. I believe that governments should do so to a moderate extent, with subsidies that are temporary and aimed at those who need them.

To begin with, subsidies speed up the shift to cleaner transport. Buyers face high prices and a lack of chargers, so support increases adoption and cuts emissions. A family on a modest income, for example, may only buy an electric car if a grant reduces the price, and each additional electric car replaces a polluting one. As more cars are sold, factories can produce at a larger scale and batteries become cheaper, which eventually removes the need for help. Transport is a major source of greenhouse gases and city air pollution, so early adoption brings benefits to public health as well as to the climate. Subsidies also encourage manufacturers and investors to build charging networks.

However, unlimited subsidies have drawbacks. Grants mostly benefit wealthy households that would have bought an electric car anyway, and they cost public money that could improve public transport, which helps everyone, including people without cars. Support should therefore be time-limited, based on income and linked to investment in charging points, and it should decrease as prices fall. Some countries have already ended or reduced grants once sales were established. Governments may also need to ensure that electricity is produced from clean sources, otherwise the environmental benefit will be limited. Subsidies for used electric cars could help poorer buyers as well.

In conclusion, governments should subsidise electric vehicle purchases to a moderate extent, but only in a temporary, targeted way that is combined with charging infrastructure.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Sales of electric cars are growing** — doanh số xe điện đang tăng
- **cost more than petrol models** — đắt hơn các mẫu xe xăng
- **subsidise their purchase** — trợ cấp việc mua chúng
- **temporary and aimed at those who need them** — tạm thời và nhắm vào những người cần
- **speed up the shift to cleaner transport** — đẩy nhanh việc chuyển sang giao thông sạch hơn
- **a lack of chargers** — thiếu trạm sạc
- **increases adoption and cuts emissions** — tăng mức độ áp dụng và giảm khí thải
- **a family on a modest income** — một gia đình thu nhập khiêm tốn
- **a grant reduces the price** — khoản trợ cấp làm giảm giá
- **replaces a polluting one** — thay thế một chiếc xe gây ô nhiễm
- **produce at a larger scale** — sản xuất ở quy mô lớn hơn
- **batteries become cheaper** — pin trở nên rẻ hơn
- **greenhouse gases and city air pollution** — khí nhà kính và ô nhiễm không khí đô thị
- **build charging networks** — xây dựng mạng lưới trạm sạc
- **Grants mostly benefit wealthy households** — trợ cấp chủ yếu có lợi cho hộ giàu
- **would have bought an electric car anyway** — dù sao cũng sẽ mua xe điện
- **public money** — tiền công
- **improve public transport** — cải thiện giao thông công cộng
- **People without cars** — những người không có xe hơi
- **time-limited, based on income** — có thời hạn, dựa trên thu nhập
- **linked to investment in charging points** — gắn với đầu tư vào các điểm sạc
- **produced from clean sources** — được sản xuất từ nguồn sạch
- **used electric cars** — xe điện đã qua sử dụng
- **temporary** — tạm thời

Opinion

#156 Opinion · 282 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how corporate social responsibility affects consumer choices.

Many supermarket shelves carry products labelled fair trade, organic or recycled, and this essay will discuss how corporate social responsibility affects consumer choices, focusing on ethical preferences and on trust.

To begin with, corporate social responsibility shapes consumer choice because many shoppers prefer ethical brands. Customers reward companies that treat workers fairly and protect the environment. A shopper who has two similar pairs of trainers at similar prices, for example, may choose the one made by a brand that publishes its factory standards and uses recycled materials. Surveys show that many people, especially the young, are willing to pay a little more for products that are ethical, and they may stop buying from companies that are connected with child labour or pollution. Strong programmes also build loyalty, since customers feel that they share the company's values and are contributing to a good cause.

However, greenwashing and higher prices can limit the effect. Some companies advertise small ethical gestures while continuing harmful practices, which makes consumers cynical, and families on tight budgets cannot always afford more expensive goods. Honest, visible responsibility builds loyalty. A company that publishes how it treats its suppliers and what it does to cut waste, for example, gives customers real information on which to base their decision. Firms must back their claims with independent certification, clear reports and real changes in their supply chains, and governments can punish false claims. Consumers should look for trusted labels and ask questions before they buy. When companies and shoppers both take responsibility seriously, ethical behaviour becomes an advantage in the market rather than a cost.

In conclusion, corporate social responsibility influences consumer choices considerably, particularly where it is genuine and well communicated.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **products labelled fair trade, organic or recycled** — sản phẩm gắn nhãn thương mại công bằng, hữu cơ hoặc tái chế
- **corporate social responsibility affects consumer choices** — trách nhiệm xã hội doanh nghiệp ảnh hưởng đến lựa chọn của người tiêu dùng
- **shoppers prefer ethical brands** — người mua ưa thích thương hiệu đạo đức
- **Customers reward companies that treat workers fairly and protect the environment** — khách hàng thưởng cho công ty đối xử công bằng với công nhân và bảo vệ môi trường
- **two similar pairs of trainers at similar prices** — hai đôi giày thể thao tương tự với giá tương đương
- **publishes its factory standards** — công bố tiêu chuẩn nhà máy của mình
- **uses recycled materials** — dùng vật liệu tái chế
- **willing to pay a little more** — sẵn lòng trả thêm một chút
- **child labour or pollution** — lao động trẻ em hoặc ô nhiễm
- **build loyalty** — xây dựng lòng trung thành
- **share the company's values** — chia sẻ giá trị của công ty
- **greenwashing** — tẩy xanh
- **small ethical gestures** — những cử chỉ đạo đức nhỏ
- **harmful practices** — hành vi có hại
- **families on tight budgets** — các gia đình có ngân sách eo hẹp
- **independent certification, clear reports** — chứng nhận độc lập, báo cáo rõ ràng
- **supply chains** — chuỗi cung ứng
- **punish false claims** — phạt các tuyên bố sai
- **trusted labels** — nhãn đáng tin cậy
- **an advantage in the market rather than a cost** — lợi thế trên thị trường thay vì một chi phí

#243 Opinion · 265 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the role of advertising in shaping consumer culture.

Billboards, television adverts and online banners surround us, and this essay will discuss the role of advertising in shaping consumer culture, focusing on the creation of wants and on its social effects.

To begin with, advertising shapes consumer culture by creating wants and defining what is fashionable. Constant messages link products to identity and success, so people buy for status. A teenager who sees a sports shoe worn by a famous player in every advertisement, for example, may feel that he needs it in order to fit in, although his old shoes still work. Advertisers use emotion, humour and attractive images to make goods appear exciting, and new models are presented as essential every year. Seasonal campaigns such as sales and gift seasons teach people to spend at certain times. Over time, this builds a culture in which shopping is a leisure activity and possessions measure personal worth.

However, advertising also has useful functions. It informs buyers about new products, prices and choices, and it makes competition between companies possible, which can lower prices. Advertising revenue pays for much of the media, from free websites to television channels. Some campaigns promote health, safety or charity, and can influence behaviour in positive ways. Consumers need critical awareness. Schools can teach young people to recognise persuasion techniques, regulators can ban misleading claims and limit advertising to children, and individuals can ask themselves whether they really need a product before buying it.

In conclusion, advertising plays a major role in shaping consumer culture by creating wants and setting social standards, although it also informs and funds the media.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Billboards, television adverts and online banners surround us** — biển quảng cáo, quảng cáo truyền hình và banner trực tuyến bao quanh chúng ta
- **shaping consumer culture** — định hình văn hoá tiêu dùng
- **creating wants and defining what is fashionable** — tạo ra ham muốn và định nghĩa cái gì là thời thượng
- **link products to identity and success** — gắn sản phẩm với bản sắc và thành công
- **buy for status** — mua vì địa vị
- **a sports shoe worn by a famous player** — một đôi giày thể thao do cầu thủ nổi tiếng mang
- **fit in** — hoà nhập
- **his old shoes still work** — đôi giày cũ của cậu vẫn dùng được
- **emotion, humour and attractive images** — cảm xúc, sự hài hước và hình ảnh hấp dẫn
- **new models are presented as essential every year** — các mẫu mới được giới thiệu như thiết yếu mỗi năm
- **sales and gift seasons** — đợt giảm giá và mùa tặng quà
- **shopping is a leisure activity** — mua sắm là một hoạt động giải trí
- **possessions measure personal worth** — tài sản đo lường giá trị cá nhân
- **informs buyers about new products, prices and choices** — thông báo cho người mua về sản phẩm, giá cả và lựa chọn mới
- **Competition between companies** — sự cạnh tranh giữa các công ty
- **Advertising revenue pays for much of the media** — doanh thu quảng cáo chi trả cho phần lớn truyền thông
- **promote health, safety or charity** — quảng bá sức khoẻ, an toàn hoặc từ thiện
- **recognise persuasion techniques** — nhận biết các kỹ thuật thuyết phục
- **ban misleading claims** — cấm những tuyên bố gây hiểu lầm

#418 Opinion · 281 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how microfinance impacts small entrepreneurs.

In villages and city slums, a small loan can mean the difference between a stall that stays closed and one that supports a family, and this essay will discuss how microfinance impacts small entrepreneurs, focusing on access to capital and on the risks of debt.

To begin with, microfinance can help small entrepreneurs start and grow businesses. Tiny loans let poor people buy stock or tools and earn income, especially women. A woman who borrows the equivalent of fifty dollars to buy a sewing machine, for example, can make clothes to sell, repay the loan from her profits and then borrow again to expand. Traditional banks usually refuse such customers because they have no property and the loans are too small to be profitable. Microfinance institutions use group lending and community pressure instead of collateral, and many provide training and savings accounts. Studies have found that access to credit increases household income, improves food and schooling and gives women more influence at home.

However, high interest and debt traps limit the benefits. Because administration is costly, rates can be very high, and borrowers who cannot repay may take new loans to pay old ones, falling deeper into debt. Pressure from group members or collectors can cause stress and, in extreme cases, tragedy. Not every borrower is a natural entrepreneur, and many use loans for consumption instead of investing. Training and regulation make it work. Lenders should offer business advice, set fair interest rates and avoid abusive collection, and governments should supervise the sector and promote savings and insurance products alongside credit.

In conclusion, microfinance can empower small entrepreneurs by giving them capital, but it needs responsible lending to prevent debt problems.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a small loan can mean the difference** — một khoản vay nhỏ có thể tạo nên sự khác biệt
- **microfinance impacts small entrepreneurs** — tài chính vi mô tác động đến các doanh nhân nhỏ
- **access to capital and on the risks of debt** — khả năng tiếp cận vốn và rủi ro nợ nần
- **start and grow businesses** — bắt đầu và phát triển doanh nghiệp
- **Tiny loans let poor people buy stock or tools** — khoản vay nhỏ giúp người nghèo mua hàng hoá hoặc dụng cụ
- **borrows the equivalent of fifty dollars** — vay số tiền tương đương năm mươi đô la
- **buy a sewing machine** — mua một chiếc máy may
- **repay the loan from her profits** — trả khoản vay từ lợi nhuận của cô
- **borrow again to expand** — vay lại để mở rộng
- **no property** — không có tài sản
- **too small to be profitable** — quá nhỏ để có lãi
- **group lending and community pressure instead of collateral** — cho vay nhóm và áp lực cộng đồng thay cho tài sản thế chấp
- **training and savings accounts** — đào tạo và tài khoản tiết kiệm
- **access to credit increases household income** — tiếp cận tín dụng làm tăng thu nhập hộ gia đình
- **gives women more influence at home** — trao cho phụ nữ nhiều ảnh hưởng hơn ở nhà
- **high interest and debt traps** — lãi suất cao và bẫy nợ
- **take new loans to pay old ones** — vay khoản mới để trả khoản cũ
- **Pressure from group members or collectors** — áp lực từ các thành viên nhóm hoặc người thu nợ
- **use loans for consumption instead of investing** — dùng khoản vay để tiêu dùng thay vì đầu tư
- **fair interest rates** — lãi suất công bằng
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm

#485 Opinion · 287 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of local markets in preserving food diversity.

On a Saturday morning, stalls piled with heirloom tomatoes, unusual beans and rare fruits attract crowds in many towns, and this essay will discuss the role of local markets in preserving food diversity, focusing on traditional varieties and on small farmers.

To begin with, local markets preserve food diversity by giving small farmers a place to sell traditional varieties. Supermarkets favour a few uniform, long-lasting products, whereas market stalls sell local, seasonal and rare crops. A farmer who grows an old variety of apple that is sweet but bruises easily, for example, cannot supply a supermarket chain, but she can sell it at a market where customers appreciate its taste. Without this outlet, such crops would disappear because there would be no reason to grow them. Seeds that are passed from one generation to the next carry genetic variety that is valuable for resisting disease and climate change. Markets also let shoppers taste, ask questions and discover unfamiliar products.

Furthermore, markets keep recipes and culture alive. Cooks learn from sellers how to prepare unusual vegetables, and traditional dishes depend on local ingredients that supermarkets do not stock. Direct sales give farmers a fairer share of the price, which helps them to stay on the land and to keep growing diverse crops. However, markets face competition from supermarkets and rising rents, and some sell the same imported goods as shops. Support for markets protects biodiversity and culture. Councils can offer cheap stall space, protect market sites in city centres and promote events that highlight local produce, while schools can teach children about traditional foods.

In conclusion, local markets play an important role in preserving food diversity by supporting small farmers and traditional crops, and they deserve public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **stalls piled with heirloom tomatoes, unusual beans and rare fruits** — các quầy chất đầy cà chua giống cổ, đậu lạ và trái cây hiếm
- **local markets in preserving food diversity** — chợ địa phương trong việc bảo tồn sự đa dạng thực phẩm
- **traditional varieties and on small farmers** — các giống truyền thống và nông dân nhỏ
- **a place to sell traditional varieties** — nơi để bán các giống truyền thống
- **a few uniform, long-lasting products** — một vài sản phẩm đồng đều và bền lâu
- **local, seasonal and rare crops** — các loại cây trồng địa phương, theo mùa và quý hiếm
- **an old variety of apple that is sweet but bruises easily** — một giống táo cũ ngọt nhưng dễ bị dập
- **supply a supermarket chain** — cung cấp cho chuỗi siêu thị
- **customers appreciate its taste** — khách hàng trân trọng hương vị của nó
- **would disappear** — sẽ biến mất
- **passed from one generation to the next** — truyền từ thế hệ này sang thế hệ khác
- **genetic variety that is valuable for resisting disease and climate change** — sự đa dạng di truyền có giá trị trong việc chống bệnh và biến đổi khí hậu
- **taste, ask questions and discover unfamiliar products** — nếm thử, đặt câu hỏi và khám phá những sản phẩm lạ
- **keep recipes and culture alive** — giữ cho công thức và văn hoá sống mãi
- **unusual vegetables** — các loại rau lạ
- **a fairer share of the price** — phần giá công bằng hơn
- **stay on the land** — ở lại trên đất của mình
- **keep growing** — tiếp tục tăng
- **competition from supermarkets and rising rents** — cạnh tranh từ siêu thị và giá thuê tăng
- **cheap stall space** — chỗ bày quầy giá rẻ